UK Driving Theory Test: all maps

Complete pack

Version 0.1.0 · content checked on 12 Oct 2026

60
revision maps, one topic per A4 page

63
practice questions with explanations

179
common traps to avoid

HOW TO USE THESE MAPS

- Each map covers one topic on one A4 page.
- Read the key facts, study the visual, then cover the answer and try the test question.
- Finish with the traps: they are the mistakes that cost marks.
- The code in the footer (for example 4.01) tells you the area and the map number.

LEGEND

01 Road & Traffic Signs
02 Rules of the Road
03 Motorways
04 Safety Margins & Vehicle Handling
05 Hazard Awareness & Vulnerable Road Users
06 Your Vehicle, Documents & Incidents

LAW LAW marks a legal requirement: The Highway Code says MUST or MUST NOT. Everything else is advice you should follow.

INDEPENDENT REVISION GUIDE

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CONTENTS

01 Road & Traffic Signs

1.01 How to Read Any Sign: Shapes & Colours
1.02 Warning Signs: Junctions, Bends & Layout
1.03 Warning Signs: Hazards, Road Users & Crossings
1.04 Prohibition Signs (Red Circles)
1.05 Mandatory Signs vs Information Signs
1.06 Direction Signs: Colour by Road Type
1.07 Road Markings Along the Road
1.08 Road Markings Across the Road & at the Kerb
1.09 Traffic Lights & Filter Arrows
1.10 Signals by Police, Officials & Other Drivers
1.11 Bus, Tram & Cycle Lanes

02 Rules of the Road

2.01 Speed Limits
2.02 The Hierarchy of Road Users
2.03 Junctions: Who Goes First
2.04 Turning Left & Right, Box Junctions
2.05 Roundabouts
2.06 Mini & Multiple Roundabouts
2.07 Pedestrian Crossings
2.08 Overtaking: When and When Not
2.09 Parking & Waiting
2.10 Reversing & Turning in the Road
2.11 Lane Discipline & One-Way Streets
2.12 Lights & Horn: When to Use Them
2.13 Level Crossings & Tramways

03 Motorways

3.01 Who Can Use Motorways (and Learners)
3.02 Joining & Leaving a Motorway
3.03 Motorway Lanes & Overtaking
3.04 Motorway Signals & the Red X
3.05 Smart Motorways & Emergency Areas
3.06 Reflective Studs & Motorway Markings
3.07 Breaking Down on a Motorway

04 Safety Margins & Vehicle Handling

4.01 Stopping Distances
4.02 Following Distance: the Two-Second Rule
4.03 Wet Roads & Aquaplaning
4.04 Ice & Snow
4.05 Fog
4.06 Windy Weather
4.07 Hills, Gears & Coasting
4.08 Skids & ABS
4.09 Driving at Night & Dazzle

05 Hazard Awareness & Vulnerable Road Users

5.01 Alertness, Distractions & Phones
5.02 Tiredness
5.03 Alcohol & the Law
5.04 Drugs & Medicines
5.05 Attitude: Following Too Close & Courtesy
5.06 Pedestrians: Children, Older & Disabled People
5.07 Cyclists: Passing, Lanes & the Dutch Reach
5.08 Motorcyclists
5.09 Horse Riders & Animals
5.10 Large & Emergency Vehicles, Buses, Trams

06 Your Vehicle, Documents & Incidents

6.01 Vehicle Checks & Tyres
6.02 Eco-Safe Driving & the Environment
6.03 Seat Belts & Child Restraints
6.04 Loading & Towing
6.05 Documents: Licence, Insurance, MOT & Tax
6.06 Learner & New Driver Rules
6.07 Penalties & Points
6.08 Breakdowns & Warning Triangles
6.09 At the Scene of an Incident & First Aid
6.10 Tunnels & Vehicle Fires

How to Read Any Sign: Shapes & Colours

WHAT IT IS UK road signs follow a simple system: the shape tells you what job the sign does, and the colour tells you more about it.

READ THE SHAPE FIRST, THEN THE COLOUR

Circle = order

Tells you what you must or must not do.

Triangle = warning

Tells you about a hazard ahead.

Rectangle = information

Directions, places and facilities.

Red ring = prohibition

Mostly tells you what you must not do.

Blue circle = positive order

Mostly tells you what you must do, like 'turn left'.

STOP and GIVE WAY

Unique shapes so you recognise them at once.

KEY FACTS

- Circles give orders, triangles warn and rectangles mostly give information.
- Red circles mostly tell you what you must not do; blue circles mostly tell you what you must do.
- STOP (octagon) and GIVE WAY (upside-down triangle) have their own shapes so they stand out.
- Direction signs are colour-coded: blue for motorways, green for primary routes, white for other roads.
- A plate below a sign adds to or limits its message, for example times or distances.

EASILY CONFUSED

Blue circle

- An order: you must do it
- For example: ahead only, turn left

VS

Blue rectangle

- Mostly information, not an order
- e.g. motorway direction signs, parking signs

HOW IT SHOWS UP ON THE TEST

Q1 What does a circular sign with a red border usually tell you?

- **A Something you must not do** ✓
- B Something you must do
- C A hazard ahead
- D Directions to a place

Why: Red rings mostly prohibit. Blue circles give positive orders, triangles warn and rectangles inform.

TRAPS

Blue circles give orders and most blue rectangles inform, but the rectangular one-way traffic sign is an order too.

The upside-down triangle is GIVE WAY: an order, not a warning.

Plates under a sign change or limit what it means, such as times or distances.

SOURCES The Highway Code, Traffic signs · Know Your Traffic Signs (DfT), The signing system

Warning Signs: Junctions, Bends & Layout

WHAT IT IS Signs that warn you about a hazard ahead, such as a junction, a bend or a change in the road layout. Most are triangles with a red border.

JUNCTION, BEND AND ROAD LAYOUT WARNINGS


Crossroads


T-junction


Staggered junction


Side road

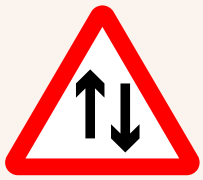

Roundabout


Bend to the right


Double bend, first to the left


Road narrows on both sides


Dual carriageway ends


Two-way traffic straight ahead

KEY FACTS

- Most warning signs are triangles with a red border, a white background and a black symbol.
- Circles give orders, triangles warn and rectangles mostly give information.
- STOP (octagon) and GIVE WAY (upside-down triangle) break the shape rule so they stand out.
- On junction signs, the broader line shows the road that has priority.
- A plate below a sign adds to its message, for example the distance to the hazard.

EASILY CONFUSED

Warning triangle (point up)
- Tells you about a hazard ahead
- Slow down and get ready to react

VS

GIVE WAY (point down)
- An order, not a warning
- Let traffic on the major road go first

HOW IT SHOWS UP ON THE TEST

Q1 What shape are most warning signs?

A Circle
B Triangle ✓
C Rectangle
D Octagon

Why: Triangles warn, circles give orders and rectangles mostly inform. The octagon is used only for STOP.

Q2 On a crossroads warning sign, one line is broader than the other. What does the broader line show?

A The road with priority ✓
B The busier road
C A dual carriageway
D The road you must turn into

Why: The broader line marks the priority route. If you're on the narrower road, expect to give way.

TRAPS

Don't mix up the upside-down GIVE WAY triangle (an order) with warning triangles (a hazard ahead).

The triangular 'roundabout ahead' sign is a warning. The blue circle with three arrows is the mini-roundabout order.

Read the plate under the sign: it can tell you the distance to the hazard or how far it goes on.

SOURCES The Highway Code, Traffic signs: warning signs · Know Your Traffic Signs (DfT), Warning signs

Warning Signs: Hazards, Road Users & Crossings

WHAT IT IS Triangular signs that warn you about people, animals and hazards ahead, from schoolchildren to level crossings.

WARNINGS ABOUT ROAD USERS, ANIMALS AND CROSSINGS



Children going to or from school



Frail (or blind or disabled) pedestrians likely to cross



Zebra crossing



Cycle route ahead



Wild animals



Accompanied horses or ponies



Level crossing with barrier or gate ahead



Level crossing without barrier or gate ahead



Traffic signals



Slippery road

KEY FACTS

- Warning signs are triangles with a red border: slow down and look for the hazard shown.
- Some school signs have amber lights that flash when children are crossing.
- Level crossing signs warn you early: be ready to stop when the lights flash.
- Animal signs mean animals may be on or near the road: slow down and give them room.
- Pedestrian signs warn that people are likely to be in or crossing the road ahead.

EASILY CONFUSED

Level crossing with barrier

- Barriers or gates come down
- The sign shows a gate

VS

Level crossing without barrier

- No gate or barrier: obey lights or give way
- The sign shows a train

HOW IT SHOWS UP ON THE TEST

Q1 You see a warning sign showing two children. What does it warn you about?

A Elderly or disabled people crossing

B **Children going to or from school** ✓

C A pedestrian zone ahead

D A play street with no traffic

Why: It's the 'children going to or from school' sign: expect children near the road and be ready to stop.

TRAPS

At level crossings, don't mix up the gate symbol (barrier) with the train symbol (no barrier).

Animal signs show which animal to expect: wild animals, wild horses or horses with riders.

A warning sign tells you about a hazard; it doesn't give you priority or an order.

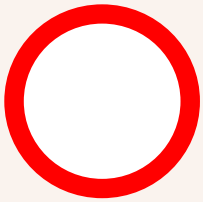
SOURCES The Highway Code, Traffic signs: warning signs · Know Your Traffic Signs (DfT), Warning signs · The Highway Code, Rule 214 (Animals)

Prohibition Signs (Red Circles)

WHAT IT IS Signs with a red ring tell you what you must not do, such as entering, turning or driving faster than a limit.

SIGNS GIVING ORDERS: RED RINGS


No entry for vehicular traffic


No vehicles except bicycles being pushed


No motor vehicles


No right turn


No left turn

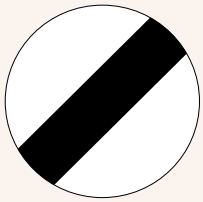

No U-turns


No overtaking


No cycling



Maximum speed


National speed limit applies

KEY FACTS

- Red rings mostly prohibit: the vehicle or action shown is not allowed.
- A number in a red ring is the maximum speed.
- The white circle with a black diagonal stripe means the national speed limit applies.
- 'No entry' (red circle, white bar) means no entry for vehicular traffic; a plate may exempt buses or cycles.
- A plate below can limit a sign to certain times or vehicles.

EASILY CONFUSED

No entry
- Red circle with a white bar
- No vehicles may enter

VS

No vehicles
- White circle with a red ring
- Except bicycles being pushed

HOW IT SHOWS UP ON THE TEST

Q1 What does a white circle with a black diagonal stripe mean?

A End of all restrictions

B **National speed limit applies** ✓

C No stopping at any time

D Minimum speed ends

Why: It's the national speed limit sign. The limit depends on the road and your vehicle: 60 mph for a car on a single carriageway, for example.

TRAPS

The national speed limit sign doesn't mean 70 mph everywhere: check the road and vehicle type.

No entry and no vehicles look alike: one has a white bar, the other is an empty red ring.

Some red-ring signs only apply at certain times: read the plate.

SOURCES The Highway Code, Traffic signs: signs giving orders · Know Your Traffic Signs (DfT), Regulatory signs

Mandatory Signs vs Information Signs

WHAT IT IS Blue circles mostly give orders you must follow. Most blue rectangles give information, but the rectangular one-way traffic sign is also an order.

BLUE CIRCLES GIVE ORDERS; BLUE RECTANGLES CAN ORDER OR INFORM



Turn left (right if symbol reversed)



Turn left ahead (right if symbol reversed)



Keep left (right if symbol reversed)



Mini-roundabout (give way to traffic from immediate right)



Route to be used by pedal cycles only



One-way traffic



No through road for vehicles

KEY FACTS

- Blue circles with no red border mostly tell you what you must do.
- Ahead only, turn left and keep left are orders, not suggestions.
- **LAW** The blue rectangular one-way traffic sign is an order: traffic MUST travel in the direction it shows.
- The mini-roundabout sign is a blue circle: give way to traffic from your right.
- Some blue circles show who may use a route, such as pedal cycles only.

EASILY CONFUSED

Ahead only (blue circle)

- An order for you
- You must go straight on

VS

One-way traffic (rectangle)

- The whole road carries one-way traffic
- Traffic MUST go the way shown (Rule 143)

HOW IT SHOWS UP ON THE TEST

Q1 What does a blue circle with a white arrow pointing left mean?

- **A Turn left** ✓
- B No left turn
- C Left lane closes ahead
- D Cycle route on the left

Why: Blue circles give orders: the arrow is the direction you must take. 'No left turn' is a red ring.

TRAPS

Most blue rectangles inform, but not all: the rectangular one-way traffic sign is an order, just like a blue circle.

The mini-roundabout sign is a blue circle, not a warning triangle.

Keep left is an order, not advice. With the arrow reversed, the same sign means keep right.

SOURCES The Highway Code, Traffic signs: signs giving orders · Know Your Traffic Signs (DfT), Regulatory signs · The Highway Code, Rule 143 (One-way streets)

Direction Signs: Colour by Road Type

WHAT IT IS Direction signs are colour-coded, so you can tell at a glance what type of road they lead to.

THE COLOUR TELLS YOU THE TYPE OF ROAD

Blue

Motorways. Motorway rules apply.

Green

Primary routes: the main roads linking towns and cities.

White (black border)

Non-primary and local routes.

Brown

Tourist attractions and facilities.

KEY FACTS

- Blue backgrounds are used on motorways.
- Green backgrounds are used on primary routes.
- White backgrounds with a black border are used on other (non-primary and local) routes.
- Brown signs point to tourist attractions and facilities.
- A blue panel on a green or white sign shows a route to a motorway.

EASILY CONFUSED

Green sign
- Primary route
- Major roads linking places

VS

Blue sign
- Motorway
- Motorway rules apply

HOW IT SHOWS UP ON THE TEST

Q1 What colour are direction signs on primary routes?

A Blue
B **Green** ✓
C White
D Brown

Why: Green is for primary routes, blue for motorways, white for other roads and brown for tourist destinations.

TRAPS

A blue panel on a green sign points to a motorway: the road you're on isn't a motorway yet.

Brown signs are for tourist places, not a type of road.

Don't mix up blue direction signs (motorways) with blue circles (orders).

SOURCES The Highway Code, Traffic signs: direction signs · Know Your Traffic Signs (DfT), Direction signs on all-purpose roads

Map 1.06 · v0.1.0 · Checked against The Highway Code on 12 Oct 2026

Road Markings Along the Road

WHAT IT IS White lines along the road divide traffic and warn of hazards. When the lines get longer and the gaps shorter, there is a hazard ahead.

YOU DRIVE FROM LEFT TO RIGHT IN THE UPPER LANE



Centre line

Short lines, long gaps: marks the middle of the road.



Hazard warning line

Long lines, short gaps: hazard ahead.



Solid line nearest you LAW

You MUST NOT cross or straddle it, with a few exceptions.



Broken line nearest you

You may cross to overtake if it's safe to do so.

KEY FACTS

- A broken white line marks the centre of the road.
- Longer lines with shorter gaps warn of a hazard: don't cross unless you can see the road is clear.
- **LAW** Where the line nearest you is solid, you MUST NOT cross or straddle it, except in the cases allowed.
- You may cross it to pass a stationary vehicle, or to overtake a cyclist, horse or works vehicle at 10 mph or less.
- Where the line nearest you is broken, you may cross to overtake if it's safe and you can finish in time.

EASILY CONFUSED

Solid line nearest you

- You MUST NOT cross or straddle it
- A few exceptions apply

VS

Broken line nearest you

- You may cross to overtake
- Only if safe and you can finish in time

HOW IT SHOWS UP ON THE TEST

Q1 There are double white lines and the one nearest you is solid. When may you cross it?

A To overtake a slow lorry

B **To pass a stationary vehicle** ✓

C When the road ahead looks clear

D Never, in any situation

Why: The exceptions include passing a stationary vehicle, turning into a side road or property, and overtaking a cyclist, horse or works vehicle at 10 mph or less.

TRAPS

'Never' is wrong: the solid line has exceptions, such as passing a stationary vehicle.

The 10 mph exception is for cyclists, horses and road maintenance vehicles, not slow cars or lorries.

A hazard warning line isn't a ban, but don't overtake unless the road is clearly safe.

SOURCES The Highway Code, Rules 127 to 132 (Lines and lane markings) · Know Your Traffic Signs (DfT), Road markings

Road Markings Across the Road & at the Kerb

WHAT IT IS Lines across the road show where to stop or give way; yellow lines and kerb marks show where you cannot wait or load.

LINES ACROSS THE ROAD AND AT THE EDGE



Give way line LAW

Give way to traffic on the road you're joining.



Stop line LAW

Used with a STOP sign: you MUST stop behind it.



Box junction LAW

Don't enter until your exit is clear.



Single yellow line

No waiting at the times shown on the plate.



Double yellow lines

No waiting at any time.



Two yellow kerb marks

No loading or unloading at any time.

KEY FACTS

- **LAW** A double broken white line across your lane means you MUST give way to traffic on the major road.
- **LAW** At a STOP sign you MUST stop behind the solid white line.
- **LAW** You MUST NOT enter a box junction until your exit road or lane is clear.
- Double yellow lines: no waiting at any time. Single yellow: no waiting at the times shown on nearby plates.
- Yellow marks on the kerb restrict loading: one mark at the times shown, two marks at any time.

EASILY CONFUSED

Yellow lines on the road	VS	Yellow marks on the kerb
• Control waiting • Single: times shown. Double: any time		• Control loading • One mark: times shown. Two: any time

HOW IT SHOWS UP ON THE TEST

Q1 When may you wait inside a yellow box junction?

- A When your exit is blocked by queuing traffic
- **B When turning right and only oncoming traffic stops you** ✓
- C Whenever the traffic lights are red
- D Never, under any circumstances

Why: You must not enter until your exit is clear, but you may wait in the box when turning right if only oncoming traffic or other right-turners are holding you up.

TRAPS

Kerb marks control loading; yellow lines control waiting.

Give way lines are broken; a STOP line is solid. At a STOP line you MUST stop, even if the road is clear.

'Never' is wrong for box junctions: turning right is the exception.

SOURCES The Highway Code, Rules 170 to 183 (Road junctions) · The Highway Code, Rules 238 to 252 (Waiting and parking) · Know Your Traffic Signs (DfT), Road markings · Know Your Traffic Signs (DfT), On-street parking control signs and road markings

Traffic Lights & Filter Arrows

WHAT IT IS Traffic lights change in a set order: red, red and amber, green, amber, then red again.

THE SEQUENCE, IN ORDER



1

Red

Stop behind the white line.



2

Red and amber

Stop: don't go yet.



3

Green

Go if the way is clear.



4

Amber

Stop, unless you've crossed the line or are so close that stopping might cause a crash.

KEY FACTS

- **LAW** Red: you MUST stop behind the white stop line.
- Red and amber: stop, and don't go until green shows.
- Green: you may go if the way is clear and there is room for you to clear the junction.
- Amber: stop, unless you've already crossed the line or stopping might cause a collision.
- A green filter arrow lets you go in that direction, even if the main green light isn't showing.
- **LAW** At an advanced stop line, you MUST stop at the first white line when the light is amber or red.

EASILY CONFUSED

Red and amber
- Comes after red
- Still means stop: green is next

VS

Amber alone
- Comes after green
- Means stop: red is next

HOW IT SHOWS UP ON THE TEST

Q1 The traffic lights show red and amber together. What should you do?

A Go if the junction is clear

B Stop and wait for green ✓

C Speed up before it turns red

D Go only if you are turning left

Why: Red and amber means stop. Don't move off until the green light shows.

TRAPS

Red and amber is not 'get ready to go': it still means stop.

A green light doesn't give you priority over people already crossing.

Don't move forward on green if you can't clear the junction.

SOURCES The Highway Code, Rules 175 to 178 (Junctions controlled by traffic lights) · The Highway Code, Light signals controlling traffic · Know Your Traffic Signs (DfT), Traffic signals

Signals by Police, Officials & Other Drivers

WHAT IT IS Signals from the police, other officials and other road users tell you what they are about to do, or what you must do.

SIGNALS YOU NEED TO KNOW

Arm signals (right arm)

Straight out: turning right. Circling: turning left. Moving up and down: slowing down.

Police asking you to stop LAW

Headlights flashing, indicator on and pointing left. Pull over safely.

Flashing headlights

Only means 'I'm here'. Make your own decision.

Horn

Only to warn others you're there, and only while moving.

Hazard warning lights

When stopped and blocking traffic. Never for dangerous or illegal parking.

School crossing patrol LAW

When a school crossing patrol shows a 'Stop for children' sign, you MUST stop.

KEY FACTS

- **LAW** You MUST obey signals from the police, traffic officers and school crossing patrols.
- **LAW** If the police signal you to stop (blue lights, headlights, left indicator), you MUST pull over and stop when safe.
- Flashing headlights should only mean 'I'm here'. Never treat it as a signal to go.
- **LAW** You MUST NOT use your horn while stationary, or between 11.30 pm and 7 am in a built-up area, unless there is danger.
- Hazard lights: when stopped and blocking traffic, or briefly on a motorway or unrestricted dual carriageway.

EASILY CONFUSED

Flashing headlights	VS	Police signal to stop
• Should only mean 'I'm here'		• Headlights, indicator, pointing left
• Never assume it means 'go'		• Pull over as soon as it's safe

HOW IT SHOWS UP ON THE TEST

Q1 Another driver flashes their headlights at you at a junction. What should you do?

A Pull out straight away

B **Make your own decision about when it is safe** ✓

C Flash your headlights back

D Sound your horn and go

Why: Flashing headlights should only mean 'I'm here'. Don't take it as an invitation: check for yourself that it's safe.

TRAPS

- Flashing headlights is not a signal to go.
- A driver gives arm signals with the right arm: circling it means you intend to turn left.
- Hazard lights don't make it OK to park where you shouldn't.

SOURCES The Highway Code, Rules 103 to 116 (Signals, stopping procedures and lighting) · The Highway Code, Signals by authorised persons · The Highway Code, Signals to other road users

Bus, Tram & Cycle Lanes

WHAT IT IS Lanes kept for buses, trams or cycles, shown by signs and road markings. Some apply only at certain times.

LANES RESERVED FOR SOME ROAD USERS



Bus lane

Thick white line. Check the sign for times and who may use it.



Mandatory cycle lane LAW

Solid line: you MUST NOT drive or park in it during its times.



Advisory cycle lane

Broken line: don't drive or park in it unless unavoidable.

KEY FACTS

- Bus lanes are shown by road markings and signs showing which other vehicles may use them, and when.
- Don't drive in a bus lane during its times of operation unless the sign allows your vehicle.

LAW You MUST NOT drive or park in a cycle lane marked by a solid white line during its times of operation.

- Don't drive or park in a cycle lane marked by a broken white line unless it's unavoidable.

LAW You MUST NOT enter a road, lane or route reserved for trams.

EASILY CONFUSED

Solid cycle lane line
- Mandatory cycle lane
- MUST NOT drive or park in it

VS

Broken cycle lane line
- Advisory cycle lane
- Avoid it unless unavoidable

HOW IT SHOWS UP ON THE TEST

Q1 A bus lane sign shows no times. When is the bus lane in operation?

A Only in the rush hours
B 24 hours a day ✓
C Only on weekdays
D Only during school terms

Why: If no times are shown, the bus lane is in operation all day, every day.

TRAPS

No times on a bus lane sign means it operates 24 hours a day.

Some bus lanes also allow taxis or cycles: the sign shows which.

Don't stop on tram tracks: a tram can't steer around you.

SOURCES The Highway Code, Rules 140 to 142 (Cycle and bus lanes) · The Highway Code, Rules 300 to 307 (Tramways) · Know Your Traffic Signs (DfT), Bus and cycle signs and road markings

Speed Limits

WHAT IT IS The speed limit is the most you may drive on that road, not a target. The national limits depend on the type of road and your vehicle.

NATIONAL SPEED LIMITS IN MPH (SIGNS CAN SET A LOWER LIMIT)

TYPE OF VEHICLE	BUILT-UP AREAS (ENGLAND, SCOTLAND)	SINGLE CARRIAGEWAYS	DUAL CARRIAGEWAYS	MOTORWAYS
Cars, motorcycles and car-derived vans (up to 2 t laden)	30	60	70	70
Cars towing caravans or trailers	30	50	60	60
Motorhomes up to 3.05 tonnes unladen	30	60	70	70
Motorhomes over 3.05 tonnes unladen	30	50	60	70
Buses, coaches and minibuses up to 12 m long	30	50	60	70 (60 if over 12 m)
Goods vehicles up to 7.5 tonnes	30	50	60	70 (60 if articulated or towing)
Goods vehicles over 7.5 tonnes (England and Wales)	30	50	60	60
Goods vehicles over 7.5 tonnes (Scotland)	30	40	50	60

These are national maximums: a lower limit shown on signs always applies.

In Wales the default limit on restricted roads (usually with street lights) has been 20 mph since 17 September 2023.

KEY FACTS

LAW You MUST NOT drive faster than the speed limit for the road and for your vehicle.

- Roads with street lights generally have a 30 mph limit (20 mph in Wales), unless signs show otherwise.
- A white circle with a black diagonal stripe means the national speed limit applies.
- Drive slower when conditions call for it: rain, fog, ice, darkness or lots of pedestrians.

EASILY CONFUSED

National speed limit sign
- Single carriageway: 60 mph for cars
- Dual carriageway: 70 mph for cars

VS

A number in a red ring
- That exact limit applies
- Until another sign changes it

HOW IT SHOWS UP ON THE TEST

Q1 You see the national speed limit sign on a single carriageway. What is the limit for a car?

- **A 60 mph** ✓
- B 50 mph
- C 70 mph
- D 40 mph

Why: On a single carriageway the national limit for cars is 60 mph. It is 70 mph on dual carriageways and motorways.

TRAPS

The national speed limit sign doesn't mean 70 mph everywhere: it depends on the road and the vehicle.

A limit is a maximum. In bad weather the safe speed can be much lower.

SOURCES The Highway Code, Rule 124 (Speed limits) · The Highway Code, Rule 125 (Speed limits are a maximum)

The Hierarchy of Road Users

WHAT IT IS Since 2022 the Highway Code says that those who can do the greatest harm have the greatest responsibility to take care and reduce the danger to others.

THREE RULES ADDED IN 2022

Rule H1: more harm, more care

Those in charge of vehicles that can cause the greatest harm have the greatest responsibility to reduce danger.

Rule H2: pedestrians at junctions

Give way to people crossing or waiting to cross the road you are turning into or out of.

Rule H2: zebra and parallel crossings

Give way to pedestrians waiting at a zebra, and to pedestrians and cyclists waiting at a parallel crossing.

Rule H3: don't cut across

Give way to cyclists and horse riders going ahead when you turn, in a lane, a track or on the road.

KEY FACTS

- The road users most at risk are pedestrians, cyclists, horse riders and motorcyclists.
- Children, older people and disabled people are even more at risk.
- At a junction, give way to pedestrians crossing or waiting to cross the road you are turning into or out of.
- Don't cut across cyclists, horse riders or horse-drawn vehicles going ahead when you turn or change lane.
- Everyone still has to take care: the hierarchy doesn't take responsibility away from anyone.

EASILY CONFUSED

Rule H2
- Protects pedestrians
- At junctions and crossings

VS

Rule H3
- Protects cyclists and horse riders
- When you turn or change lane

HOW IT SHOWS UP ON THE TEST

Q1 You are turning left into a side road. A pedestrian is waiting to cross it. What should you do?

- **A Give way and let them cross** ✓
- B Turn first, because you have priority
- C Sound your horn to warn them
- D Wave them across the road

Why: Rule H2: give way to pedestrians crossing or waiting to cross a road you are turning into. Waving people across can put them in danger.

TRAPS

The hierarchy doesn't mean pedestrians and cyclists can ignore their own safety.

"Waiting to cross" counts, not just people already in the road.

A cyclist going straight on in a cycle lane has priority over you turning across it.

SOURCES The Highway Code, Introduction: Rules H1 to H3 (Hierarchy of road users)

Junctions: Who Goes First

WHAT IT IS At a junction, signs and road markings tell you who goes first. Where there are none, nobody has priority.

WHO GOES FIRST AT A JUNCTION

STOP sign and solid line LAW

Stop at the line every time. Go when it is safe.

Give way lines (broken) LAW

You MUST give way to traffic on the main road when you emerge.

Unmarked crossroads

No one has priority. Slow down, look and go on with care.

Limited view

Look all around before emerging. Don't join the road until there is a safe gap.

KEY FACTS

- Before you emerge, look all around: cyclists, motorcyclists and pedestrians are easy to miss.
- **LAW** At a STOP sign you MUST stop at the solid white line, even if the road is clear.
- **LAW** At broken give way lines you MUST give way to traffic on the main road when you emerge.
- At an unmarked crossroads nobody has priority: go on with great care.
- Crossing a dual carriageway: if the central reservation is too shallow for your vehicle, cross in one go.

EASILY CONFUSED

STOP sign
- You MUST stop at the line
- Even when the road is clear

VS

GIVE WAY sign
- You MUST give way to traffic on the major road
- Broken lines, not a solid stop line

HOW IT SHOWS UP ON THE TEST

Q1 You arrive at a STOP sign. The road is clear. What must you do?

- **A Stop at the line, then go when it is safe** ✓
- B Slow down and go if it is clear
- C Stop only if traffic is coming
- D Sound your horn and go

Why: At a STOP sign you must always stop at the solid white line, even if you can see the road is clear.

TRAPS

A clear road doesn't excuse you from stopping at a STOP sign.

At an unmarked crossroads nobody has priority, not even traffic from the right.

Cyclists and motorcyclists are not always easy to see: look all around before you emerge.

SOURCES The Highway Code, Rules 170 to 173 (Road junctions) · The Highway Code, Rule 146 (Adapt your driving)

Turning Left & Right, Box Junctions

WHAT IT IS Turning safely means Mirrors – Signal – Manoeuvre, the right position and a safe gap. Box junctions keep junctions clear of queuing traffic.

MIRRORS – SIGNAL – MANOEUVRE, STEP BY STEP

1 Mirrors

Check what is behind and beside you, including bikes on your left.

2 Signal

Signal in good time so others know what you plan to do.

3 Position

Left turn: keep left. Right turn: just left of the centre line.

4 Give way

Give way to pedestrians crossing or waiting to cross the road you're turning into.

5 Look

Look for traffic and pedestrians, then turn when it is safe.

KEY FACTS

- Turning right: position just left of the middle of the road, or in the lane marked for turning right.
- Wait for a safe gap in the oncoming traffic, and don't cut the corner.
- Turning left: keep close to the left and watch for cyclists, motorcyclists and pedestrians on your left.
- Don't overtake just before you turn left.

LAW You MUST NOT enter a box junction unless your exit road or lane is clear.

- You may wait in a box when turning right if only oncoming traffic or other right-turners stop you.

EASILY CONFUSED

Right side to right side

- Both turn right passing behind each other
- Usually the safest way

VS

Left side to left side

- Both turn right passing in front
- Your view of oncoming traffic is blocked

HOW IT SHOWS UP ON THE TEST

Q1 You are turning left into a side road. Who should you watch for most carefully?

- **A Cyclists coming up on your left** ✓
- B Vehicles overtaking you on the right
- C Oncoming lorries
- D Cars parked on the right

Why: Cyclists and motorcyclists can be on your left as you turn. Check your left mirror and blind spot before you turn.

TRAPS

A signal tells others your plan: it doesn't give you priority.

A box junction isn't a place to wait in a queue. Turning right is the only exception.

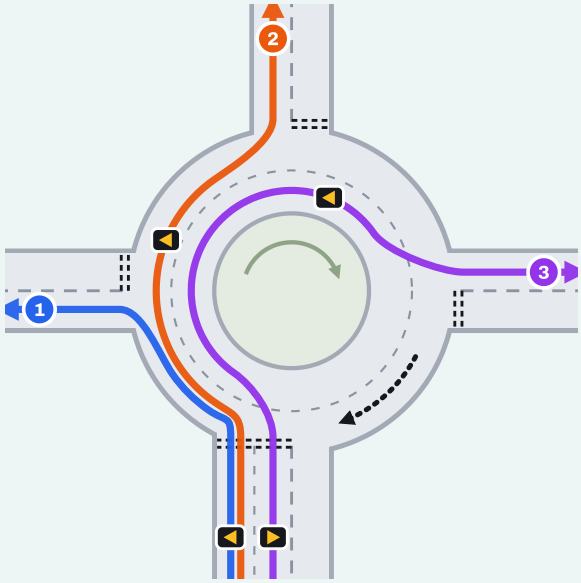
Don't cut the corner when turning right.

SOURCES The Highway Code, Rules 174 to 183 (Road junctions) · The Highway Code, Rules 159 to 161 (Mirrors – Signal – Manoeuvre)

Roundabouts

WHAT IT IS A junction where traffic goes round a central island. Give priority to traffic approaching from your right, unless signs, markings or lights say otherwise.

LANES AND SIGNALS AT A FOUR-WAY ROUNDABOUT



1 1st exit · turning left
Signal left and approach in the left lane
Keep to the left and keep signalling left

2 2nd exit · going ahead
Choose the appropriate lane; usually no signal on approach
Signal left after passing the 1st exit

3 3rd exit · turning right
Signal right and approach in the right lane
Keep to the right on the roundabout
Signal left after passing the 2nd exit

Give way to traffic from your right
Traffic goes round clockwise
Signal left Signal right

KEY FACTS

- Use Mirrors – Signal – Manoeuvre at every stage and decide on your exit early.
- Give way to traffic from your right, unless signs, road markings or traffic lights say otherwise.
- Follow lane markings. Where there are none, pick the lane that suits your exit.
- **LAW** At a mini-roundabout you MUST go round the central marking (except large vehicles that can't).
- At double or multiple roundabouts, treat each one separately.
- Watch for cyclists, motorcyclists, horse riders and long vehicles on the roundabout.

EASILY CONFUSED

Roundabout
- Raised central island
- Warning sign: triangle with arrows going round

VS

Mini-roundabout
- White central circle marked on the road
- Blue circular sign with three white arrows
- Less space and time: avoid U-turns

HOW IT SHOWS UP ON THE TEST

Q1 You're going straight ahead at a roundabout (2nd exit). When should you signal left?

A As you approach the roundabout
B After passing the exit before the one you want ✓
C Only if there is traffic behind you
D You never need to signal

Why: Going ahead, you don't normally signal on approach. Signal left once you've passed the exit before yours.

Q2 A cyclist on the roundabout is in the left lane and signalling right. What should you do?

A Sound your horn to warn them
B Overtake them quickly on the right
C Give them plenty of room ✓
D Assume they'll take the next exit

Why: Cyclists and horse riders may stay in the left lane and signal right if they're going round. Give them space and let them cross your path.

TRAPS

Going ahead? Don't signal left on approach: signal left only after passing the exit before yours.

A cyclist or horse rider in the left lane may be going all the way round.

Long vehicles may need more than one lane: hang back and watch their signals.

SOURCES The Highway Code, Rules 184–190 (Roundabouts)

Mini & Multiple Roundabouts

WHAT IT IS Mini-roundabouts follow the same rules as large ones, with less space and less time. At double or multiple roundabouts, treat each one separately.

MINI AND MULTIPLE ROUNDABOUTS

Mini-roundabout

Same rules as a big one: give way to traffic from the right.

The white circle LAW

Drive round it. Only large vehicles may drive over it if they must.

U-turns

Avoid them here, and expect other drivers to make them.

Double or multiple

Treat each roundabout on its own. Give way to the right at each one.

KEY FACTS

- Give way to traffic from your right, as at any roundabout.
- **LAW** You MUST drive round the central marking. Only large vehicles that can't get round may drive over it.
- There is less space to manoeuvre and less time to signal.
- Avoid U-turns at mini-roundabouts, and watch out for others making them.
- At double and multiple roundabouts, treat each roundabout separately and give way to traffic from the right at each one.

EASILY CONFUSED

Mini-roundabout sign

- Blue circle with white arrows
- An order: give way to traffic from the right

VS

Roundabout ahead sign

- Red triangle with black arrows
- A warning: a roundabout is coming

HOW IT SHOWS UP ON THE TEST

Q1 At a mini-roundabout, which vehicles may drive over the central white circle?

- **A Large vehicles that can't get round it** ✓
- B Any vehicle turning right
- C Cars when the roundabout is empty
- D Only motorcycles

Why: All vehicles must go round the central marking. The only exception is large vehicles that physically can't.

TRAPS

A mini-roundabout is still a roundabout: give way to traffic from the right.

Driving over the white circle in a car breaks the rule.

At a double mini-roundabout, give way at each one, not just the first.

SOURCES The Highway Code, Rules 188 to 190 (Mini-roundabouts and multiple roundabouts)

Map 2.06 · v0.1.0 · Checked against The Highway Code on 12 Oct 2026

Pedestrian Crossings

WHAT IT IS Each type of crossing works a little differently. Know who uses it and what the lights mean for you.

KNOW YOUR CROSSINGS

Zebra

Black and white stripes and flashing amber beacons. No lights for traffic.

Pelican

Push-button lights. Has a flashing amber phase after the red.

Puffin

Sensors watch the crossing. No flashing amber: normal light sequence.

Toucan

Pedestrians and cyclists cross together. No flashing amber.

Equestrian

For horse riders, with higher push buttons. Often next to a toucan.

Parallel

A zebra with a cycle crossing beside it. Give way to both.

KEY FACTS

LAW You MUST NOT park on a crossing or on its zigzag lines.

LAW On the zigzags you MUST NOT overtake the moving vehicle nearest the crossing, or one that has stopped for pedestrians.

LAW You MUST give way to anyone who has moved onto a zebra crossing. Give way to those waiting, too.

LAW Flashing amber at a pelican: you MUST give way to anyone on the crossing, then go if it is clear.

- Don't wave people across or sound your horn to hurry them: another vehicle may not stop.
- In queuing traffic, keep the crossing clear.

EASILY CONFUSED

Pelican
- Has flashing amber
- Signals on the far side of the road

VS

Puffin
- No flashing amber
- Sensors adjust the timing

HOW IT SHOWS UP ON THE TEST

Q1 The amber light is flashing at a pelican crossing. What must you do?

- **A Give way to anyone still on the crossing** ✓
- B Stop and wait for the green light
- C Drive on, because you have priority
- D Sound your horn and drive on

Why: Flashing amber means pedestrians on the crossing still have priority. Go on only when the crossing is clear.

TRAPS

Only pelican crossings have a flashing amber phase.

Waving someone across can lead them into the path of another vehicle.

Toucan crossings are shared with cyclists: expect bikes as well as people.

SOURCES The Highway Code, Rules 191 to 199 (Pedestrian crossings) · The Highway Code, Rules 18 to 30 (Crossings, for pedestrians) · Know Your Traffic Signs (DfT), Pedestrian, cycle and equestrian crossings

Overtaking: When and When Not

WHAT IT IS Overtake only when it is safe and legal to do so. If you are in any doubt, or can't see far enough ahead to be sure, don't overtake.

DON'T OVERTAKE HERE

Bends and hill brows

Anywhere you can't see far enough ahead to be sure it is safe.

At or near junctions

Approaching or at a road junction on either side of the road.

Near a pedestrian crossing LAW

You MUST NOT overtake the moving vehicle nearest the crossing, or one stopped for pedestrians.

Solid white line nearest you LAW

You MUST NOT cross or straddle it, except in a few cases.

School crossing patrols

When approaching a school crossing patrol.

Level crossings

Don't overtake at a level crossing.

KEY FACTS

- Before you overtake, make sure the road ahead is clear far enough and nobody is overtaking you.
- Overtake on the right. Move back in when it is safe, without cutting in.
- You may pass on the left when the vehicle in front is turning right and there is room.
- When someone overtakes you, keep a steady speed or slow down. Never speed up.
- If a queue builds up behind you, pull in where it is safe and let them pass.

EASILY CONFUSED

Passing on the left: OK

- Vehicle ahead is turning right
- Queues where your lane is faster

VS

Passing on the left: no

- To get past a slow driver
- Moving left on a motorway to overtake

HOW IT SHOWS UP ON THE TEST

Q1 Another vehicle is overtaking you. What should you do?

- **A Keep a steady speed, or slow down** ✓
- B Speed up to stop them passing
- C Move towards the middle of the road
- D Brake hard to let them in

Why: Keep a steady speed and slow down if needed to let them back in safely. Speeding up puts everyone at risk.

TRAPS

A broken centre line doesn't make it safe near junctions, bends or hill brows.

A vehicle signalling right may be about to turn: never pass it on the right.

Being overtaken? Speeding up is dangerous and aggressive.

SOURCES The Highway Code, Rules 162 to 169 (Overtaking)

Parking & Waiting

WHAT IT IS Park where you won't put anyone in danger or block the way. Some of these rules are the law.

DON'T PARK HERE

Within 10 m of a junction

Rule 243: not opposite or within 10 m of a junction, except in an authorised parking space.

Near a school entrance

Keep school entrance markings clear, even when picking up or setting down children.

Near a bus or tram stop

Don't stop or park at or near a bus or tram stop, or a taxi rank.

On a bend or hill brow

Also avoid the brow of a hill or a hump bridge (Rule 243).

At a lowered kerb

Lowered to help wheelchair users and powered mobility vehicles.

On zigzag lines LAW

You MUST NOT stop or park on a crossing or on its zigzag lines.

KEY FACTS

- **LAW** Before you leave the car you MUST switch off the engine, headlights and fog lights and apply the handbrake.
- Don't park within 10 metres of a junction, except in an authorised parking space.
- **LAW** At night you MUST NOT park on a road facing against the traffic, unless in a recognised parking space.
- **LAW** On a road with a limit over 30 mph, you MUST use parking lights when parked at night.
- Parking on a hill: uphill, turn the wheels away from the kerb; downhill, turn them towards it.

EASILY CONFUSED

Parking lights	vs	Hazard warning lights
For parking at night		Not for parking
Needed on roads over 30 mph		When stopped and temporarily blocking traffic

HOW IT SHOWS UP ON THE TEST

Q1 You park at night on a road with a 40 mph limit. What must you do?

- **A Leave your parking lights on** ✓
- B Leave your hazard lights on
- C Park facing the oncoming traffic
- D Leave your dipped headlights on

Why: On roads with a limit above 30 mph, vehicles parked at night must show parking lights.

TRAPS

- It is 10 metres from a junction, not 10 car lengths.
- Hazard lights are not a licence to park where you shouldn't.
- At night, park facing the same way as the traffic on your side.

SOURCES The Highway Code, Rules 238 to 252 (Waiting and parking) · The Highway Code, Road markings

Reversing & Turning in the Road

WHAT IT IS Reversing and turning round need care: choose a safe place, look all around and reverse slowly.

REVERSING SAFELY

1 Pick the place

A safe place. Don't reverse or turn round in a busy road: find a quiet side road.

2 Look all round

Mirrors and blind spots. Look for children and cyclists.

3 Go slowly

Reverse slowly, checking all around and looking mainly through the rear window.

4 Keep looking

Look mainly out of the rear window, and all around.

5 Give way

Give way to any pedestrians who may be crossing the road behind you.

KEY FACTS

- Choose a safe place: avoid turning round in a busy road. Find a quiet side road or go round the block.
- Don't reverse from a side road into a main road.
- At a driveway, reverse in and drive out forwards if you can.
- **LAW** You MUST NOT reverse further than you need to.
- If you can't see properly behind you, get someone to guide you.

EASILY CONFUSED

Driveway: reverse in

- Then drive out forwards
- Rule 201: do this if you can

VS

Driveway: reverse out

- Reversing out into the road
- Rule 201: reverse in and drive out instead

HOW IT SHOWS UP ON THE TEST

Q1 You need to turn your car round on a busy road. What should you do?

- **A Find a quiet side road or drive round the block** ✓
- B Make a U-turn where the road is widest
- C Reverse into the busy road
- D Turn in the road using the kerbs

Why: Avoid turning round in busy roads. Find a quiet side road or drive round a block of side streets.

TRAPS

Mirrors alone aren't enough: look out of the rear window and all around.

Before reversing, check there are no pedestrians, particularly children, in the road behind you.

Never reverse from a side road into a main road.

SOURCES The Highway Code, Rules 200 to 203 (Reversing) · The Highway Code, Rule 206 (Pedestrians)

Lane Discipline & One-Way Streets

WHAT IT IS Keep to the left unless you are overtaking or turning right, and pick your lane early. In one-way streets traffic can pass on both sides.

IN A ONE-WAY STREET

Turning left

Use the left-hand lane, unless signs or markings say otherwise.

Turning right

Use the right-hand lane, unless signs or markings say otherwise.

Going straight ahead

Use the most suitable lane for where you are going.

Traffic on both sides

Others may pass you on the left or the right. Check both mirrors.

KEY FACTS

- Keep to the left-hand lane unless road signs or markings tell you otherwise.
- On a two-lane dual carriageway, use the right-hand lane only to overtake or turn right, then move back.
- On a three-lane single carriageway, use the middle lane only to overtake or turn right: oncoming traffic can too.
- Follow lane arrows and get into the right lane in good time. Don't change lanes suddenly.

LAW In a one-way street, traffic MUST go in the direction shown by the signs.

EASILY CONFUSED

Dual carriageway, 2 lanes

- Right lane: overtaking or turning right
- Move back left when it is safe

VS

Single carriageway, 3 lanes

- Middle lane shared with oncoming traffic
- Overtake only if it is clear

HOW IT SHOWS UP ON THE TEST

Q1 You are in a one-way street and want to turn right. Which lane should you use?

- **A The right-hand lane** ✓
- B The left-hand lane
- C Any lane you like
- D The middle of the road

Why: Unless signs or markings say otherwise, use the right-hand lane to turn right in a one-way street.

TRAPS

In a one-way street you can be passed on either side.

Don't sit in the right lane of a dual carriageway once you have overtaken.

On a three-lane road, oncoming drivers may use the middle lane too.

SOURCES The Highway Code, Rules 133 to 143 (Multi-lane carriageways and one-way streets) · The Highway Code, Rule 160 (Once moving)

Lights & Horn: When to Use Them

WHAT IT IS Lights help you see and be seen; the horn warns others you are there. Both have rules about when to use them.

WHICH LIGHT, WHEN

Dipped headlights

At night in built-up areas, and in dull weather so others can see you.

Main beam

Never let it dazzle others. When overtaking, stay dipped until you're level.

Fog lights LAW

Only when you can't see more than about 100 m. Off when it clears.

Hazard warning lights

Stopped and blocking traffic, or briefly on a motorway or unrestricted dual carriageway.

Horn

Only while moving, to warn others you are there. Never in anger.

Flashing headlights

Only to let others know you are there. Not to say "go".

KEY FACTS

- **LAW** At night you MUST use headlights, except on roads with lit street lights.
- **LAW** You MUST NOT use lights in a way that dazzles or bothers other road users.
- **LAW** You MUST use headlights when visibility is seriously reduced, usually under 100 metres.
- **LAW** You MUST NOT use fog lights unless visibility is seriously reduced.
- **LAW** You MUST NOT use your horn while stationary, or in a built-up area from 11.30 pm to 7 am, unless there is danger.

EASILY CONFUSED

Dipped headlights
- Night in towns, dull weather
- Normal lights for being seen

VS

Fog lights
- Visibility under about 100 m
- Switch off as soon as it clears

HOW IT SHOWS UP ON THE TEST

Q1 When may you use front or rear fog lights?

- **A When visibility is seriously reduced** ✓
- B Whenever it is raining
- C At night on unlit roads
- D To warn of a hazard ahead

Why: Fog lights are only for when visibility is seriously reduced, generally under 100 metres. Otherwise they dazzle others and hide your brake lights.

TRAPS

Fog lights used when visibility isn't seriously reduced dazzle others and can hide your brake lights.

Don't let your lights dazzle anyone. When overtaking, keep dipped until you are level with the other vehicle.

The horn is a warning, not a way to tell people off.

SOURCES The Highway Code, Rules 110 to 116 (Flashing headlights, horn and lighting) · The Highway Code, Rules 226 and 236 (Adverse weather: overview and fog)

Level Crossings & Tramways

WHAT IT IS At level crossings trains always have priority. Trams run on fixed rails, so they can't steer round you.

AT A CROSSING WITH LIGHTS AND BARRIERS

1 Amber light and alarm

Stop, unless you have already crossed the stop line.

2 Flashing red lights

You MUST stop and wait behind the white line.

3 Barriers come down

Never zigzag round them or move onto the crossing.

4 Train passes

Lights still flashing? Another train is coming: keep waiting.

5 Lights off, barriers up

Cross when the way is clear, without stopping on it.

KEY FACTS

- **LAW** You MUST obey the flashing red lights at a level crossing and stop.
- **LAW** If the lights keep flashing after a train has passed, you MUST wait: another train is coming.
- Never stop on a level crossing. In queues, keep the crossing clear.
- Broken down on a crossing? Get everyone out and clear first, then phone the signal operator.
- **LAW** You MUST NOT enter a road, lane or route reserved for trams.
- Trams can be quiet and can't steer round you: never stop on the tracks.

EASILY CONFUSED

Steady amber	VS	Flashing red
• Comes first • Stop unless you've crossed the line		• A train is coming • You MUST stop

HOW IT SHOWS UP ON THE TEST

Q1 At a level crossing, the red lights keep flashing after a train has passed. What should you do?

- **A Wait, because another train is coming** ✓
- B Drive across carefully
- C Go round the barriers
- D Phone the signal operator

Why: If the lights keep flashing after a train passes, another train is coming. Wait until the lights go off and the barriers rise.

TRAPS

- Never zigzag round half-barriers.
- Broken down on the crossing: people out first, then phone.
- A tram can't swerve: keep off tram tracks when you stop.

SOURCES The Highway Code, Rules 291 to 299 (Level crossings) · The Highway Code, Rules 300 to 307 (Tramways) · The Highway Code, Rule 224 (Electric vehicles)

Who Can Use Motorways (and Learners)

WHAT IT IS Traffic on motorways is fast, so you have less time to react. Some road users are not allowed on them at all.

WHO MAY USE A MOTORWAY

Pedestrians LAW

Not allowed, except in an emergency.

Cyclists and horse riders LAW

Not allowed on motorways.

Motorcycles under 50 cc LAW

Not allowed on motorways, even with a full licence.

Slow vehicles LAW

Farm tractors, mobility scooters and powered wheelchairs are not allowed.

Learner car drivers LAW

Only with an approved driving instructor in a dual-control car.

Full licence holders

Cars, motorcycles of 50 cc or more, vans, lorries and buses.

KEY FACTS

- **LAW** Motorways MUST NOT be used by pedestrians, cyclists, horse riders or motorcycles under 50 cc.
- **LAW** Slow vehicles such as farm tractors, mobility scooters and powered wheelchairs MUST NOT use motorways.
- **LAW** Learner car drivers MUST NOT use motorways unless with an approved instructor in a dual-control car with L plates.
- **LAW** Learner motorcyclists MUST NOT use motorways.
- Before a motorway trip, make sure you have enough fuel or charge, and plan time for breaks.

In Wales: In Wales learners can show D plates instead of L plates.

EASILY CONFUSED

Learner with an instructor

- Allowed in a dual-control car
- L plates (D plates in Wales)

VS

Learner with a parent

- Not allowed on a motorway
- However experienced the parent is

HOW IT SHOWS UP ON THE TEST

Q1 Who can take a learner car driver on a motorway?

- **A An approved driving instructor in a dual-control car** ✓
- B Any driver aged 21 or over
- C A parent who has held a licence for 3 years
- D Nobody: learners are banned from motorways

Why: Since 2018, learner car drivers can have motorway lessons, but only with an approved driving instructor in a car with dual controls.

TRAPS

- Learners can't practise on a motorway with family or friends.
- Learner motorcyclists still can't use motorways.
- A motorcycle under 50 cc is banned, even with a full licence.

SOURCES The Highway Code, Rules 253 to 274 (Motorways) · GOV.UK, Driving lessons and learning to drive · The Highway Code, Rule 97 (Before setting off)

Joining & Leaving a Motorway

WHAT IT IS You usually join and leave a motorway by a slip road. Match your speed when joining, and plan your exit early.

JOINING AND LEAVING, STEP BY STEP

1 Slip road

Build up speed to match the traffic in the left lane.

2 Mirrors and look

Check the motorway traffic, using mirrors and a quick sideways glance.

3 Join a gap

Give way to motorway traffic. Don't force your way in.

4 Settle in

Stay in the left lane until you are used to the speed.

5 Exit early

Get into the left lane early and signal left in good time.

6 Slow on the slip

Slow down on the slip road, not on the motorway.

KEY FACTS

- On the slip road, build up your speed to match the traffic on the motorway.
- Give priority to traffic already on the motorway and join where there is a safe gap.
- Countdown markers show the distance to the start of the deceleration lane. Each bar is about 100 yards.
- Move into the left lane well before your exit, signal left in good time, and slow down on the slip road.
- After leaving, check your speedometer: you may be going faster than it feels.

EASILY CONFUSED

Joining	VS	Leaving
• Speed up on the slip road • Give way to motorway traffic		• Left lane early, then signal • Slow down on the slip road

HOW IT SHOWS UP ON THE TEST

Q1 You are joining a motorway from a slip road. What should you do?

- **A Give way to traffic already on the motorway** ✓
- B Expect motorway traffic to move over for you
- C Join slowly, then speed up in the left lane
- D Stop at the end of the slip road and wait

Why: Traffic on the motorway has priority. Match its speed on the slip road and join where there is a safe gap.

TRAPS

Traffic already on the motorway has priority: match its speed and fit into a safe gap.

Countdown markers count down to the start of the deceleration lane, about 100 yards per bar.

After the motorway, 50 mph can feel like 30: check your speedometer.

SOURCES The Highway Code, Rules 253 to 274 (Motorways) · Know Your Traffic Signs (DfT), Motorway signs, signals and road markings (p. 93, countdown markers)

Motorway Lanes & Overtaking

WHAT IT IS On a motorway the left-hand lane is your normal lane. The other lanes are for overtaking, and you move back once you have passed.

WHAT EACH LANE IS FOR

Left-hand lane

Your normal driving lane. Return to it after overtaking.

Middle and right lanes

For overtaking. Move back left when you have passed.

Towing a trailer or caravan LAW

Never the right-hand lane on a motorway with 3 or more lanes.

Hard shoulder LAW

For emergencies only, unless signs open it as a lane.

KEY FACTS

- Drive in the left-hand lane unless you are overtaking. Move back to it as soon as it is safe.
- **LAW** On motorways with 3 or more lanes, you MUST NOT use the right-hand lane if you are towing a trailer.
- Overtake only on the right. Don't move to a lane on your left to overtake.
- In queues, if the lane on your left is moving faster, you may keep going in it.
- **LAW** You MUST NOT stop on the hard shoulder, except in an emergency or when told to.

EASILY CONFUSED

Overtaking on the left
- Don't do it
- Don't move left to pass someone

VS

Queue moving faster on the left
- Allowed in congestion
- Keep going in your lane

HOW IT SHOWS UP ON THE TEST

Q1 You are towing a caravan on a three-lane motorway. Which lane must you NOT use?

- **A The right-hand lane** ✓
- B The left-hand lane
- C The middle lane
- D The hard shoulder in an emergency

Why: Vehicles towing trailers must not use the right-hand lane of a motorway with three or more lanes.

TRAPS

Once you have overtaken, move back left: don't sit in the middle lane.

Towing on a motorway: 60 mph limit, and never the right-hand lane on 3 or more lanes.

Passing on the left is only OK in queues where your lane is moving faster.

SOURCES The Highway Code, Rules 253 to 274 (Motorways) · The Highway Code, Rule 124 (Speed limits)

Motorway Signals & the Red X

WHAT IT IS Signals above the lanes and at the roadside warn of danger ahead. A red X closes a lane, and it is the law.

SIGNALS YOU MUST KNOW

Red X over your lane LAW

The lane is closed. Move to an open lane in good time.

Speed in a red ring LAW

The legal limit for that stretch, even if the road looks clear.

All lanes shown closed LAW

Red flashing lights with every lane shown closed: the road is closed. Don't go beyond the sign.

Flashing amber

Hazard ahead. Reduce your speed and be prepared for the hazard.

KEY FACTS

- **LAW** A red X above a lane means it is closed: you MUST NOT drive in that lane beyond the signal.
- **LAW** A speed limit shown in a red ring above your lane is the legal limit.
- **LAW** Red flashing lights and all lanes shown closed: the road is closed. You MUST NOT go beyond the sign in any lane.
- Flashing amber lights warn of a hazard ahead: reduce your speed and be prepared for the hazard.
- **LAW** You MUST follow signs ahead of a closed lane and move safely to an open lane.

EASILY CONFUSED

Red X over your lane	VS	All lanes shown closed
That lane is closed		The road is closed
Other lanes may stay open		Don't go beyond the sign in any lane

HOW IT SHOWS UP ON THE TEST

Q1 A red X is shown above your lane on a motorway. What does it mean?

- **A The lane is closed: move to another lane** ✓
- B Slow down to 40 mph
- C The lane is for breakdown vehicles
- D Give way to traffic joining

Why: A red X closes the lane. You must not drive in that lane past the signal, usually because of an incident or people ahead.

TRAPS

A red X is not advice: driving under it is an offence.

A speed in a red ring over the lanes is the legal limit, not a suggestion.

A roadside red X sign closes the lane it relates to. All lanes shown closed means the road is closed.

SOURCES

The Highway Code, Rules 255 to 258 (Motorway signals) · The Highway Code, Light signals controlling traffic (Motorway signals) · The Highway Code, Rule 261 (Speed limits on signs) · Know Your Traffic Signs (DfT), Motorway signs, signals and road markings (pp. 104 to 108)

Smart Motorways & Emergency Areas

WHAT IT IS Smart motorways use variable speed limits and may use the hard shoulder as a lane. Some have no hard shoulder at all.

ON A SMART MOTORWAY

Emergency areas

Blue sign with an orange SOS phone; may have an orange surface. Use one in an emergency.

Hard shoulder as a lane LAW

Only when a speed limit shows above it. Red X or blank: emergencies only.

Variable speed limits LAW

Speeds shown in a red ring over the lanes are the law.

Stuck in a live lane

Hazard lights on, seat belt on, call 999 if it isn't safe to get out.

KEY FACTS

- On some smart motorways there is no hard shoulder: in an emergency, go to an emergency area.
- Emergency areas are marked by blue signs with an orange SOS phone, and may have an orange surface.
- Use the hard shoulder as a lane only when a speed limit shows above it. Red X or blank sign: emergencies only.

LAW You MUST NOT drive in a lane closed by a red X.

- If you stop in a live lane, put hazard lights on, stay belted in and call 999 if you can't get out safely.

LAW After stopping in an emergency area, you MUST use the emergency phone before you rejoin.

EASILY CONFUSED

Speed limit above hard shoulder
- Open as a running lane
- Keep to the limit shown

VS

Red X or blank above it
- Not a running lane
- Emergencies only

HOW IT SHOWS UP ON THE TEST

Q1 You break down on a smart motorway with no hard shoulder. Where should you try to stop?

- **A In an emergency area** ✓
- B In the right-hand lane
- C Under the next overhead gantry
- D On the central reservation

Why: Try to reach an emergency area or leave at the next exit. If you can't, move as far left as you can and put your hazard lights on.

TRAPS

No speed limit over the hard shoulder means it isn't open as a lane.

Emergency areas are for emergencies, not for a rest.

Stuck in a live lane and can't get out safely? Stay belted in and call 999.

SOURCES The Highway Code, Rules 253 to 274 (Motorways) · The Highway Code, Rules 275 to 278 (Breakdowns and incidents) · Know Your Traffic Signs (DfT), Stopping on a motorway (p. 109)

Reflective Studs & Motorway Markings

WHAT IT IS Reflective studs light up in your headlights and show where the lanes and edges are, even at night or in fog.

REFLECTIVE STUDS ON A MOTORWAY

Red

The left edge of the carriageway, next to the hard shoulder.

Amber

The right edge, next to the central reservation.

White

Between the lanes (or the middle of an ordinary road).

Green

Where a slip road or lay-by joins or leaves.

Green and yellow

Temporary layouts, such as roadworks and contraflows.

Chevrons LAW

Hatched areas edged with a solid line: you MUST NOT enter unless it's an emergency.

KEY FACTS

- Driving on the left: red studs are on your left, amber studs on your right.
- Green studs mark the edge of the main carriageway at slip roads and lay-bys.
- Green and yellow studs show temporary layouts, such as roadworks.
- A solid white edge line marks the left edge of the carriageway, next to the hard shoulder.

LAW You MUST NOT enter chevrons bordered by a solid white line, except in an emergency.

EASILY CONFUSED

Red studs	VS	Amber studs
Left edge		Right edge
Next to the hard shoulder		Next to the central reservation

HOW IT SHOWS UP ON THE TEST

Q1 On a motorway, what colour are the studs between the left-hand lane and the hard shoulder?

- **A Red** ✓
- B Amber
- C Green
- D White

Why: Red studs mark the left edge of the carriageway. Amber studs mark the right edge, by the central reservation.

TRAPS

- Amber is on the right, by the central reservation, not the left.
- Green studs don't mean "go": they mark slip roads and lay-bys.
- Green and yellow studs are temporary: expect roadworks.

SOURCES The Highway Code, Rule 132 (Reflective road studs) · The Highway Code, Rule 130 (Chevrons) · Know Your Traffic Signs (DfT), Road studs (p. 84) · Know Your Traffic Signs (DfT), Edge of carriageway line (p. 78)

Breaking Down on a Motorway

WHAT IT IS Breaking down on a motorway is dangerous because traffic passes very close and fast. Get yourself and your passengers away from it.

IF YOU BREAK DOWN (WITH A HARD SHOULDER)

1 Pull over

Get onto the hard shoulder and stop as far left as you can.

2 Lights on

Hazard lights on. Sidelights too at night or in poor visibility.

3 Get out on the left

Everyone out by the left-hand doors, away from the traffic.

4 Wait behind the barrier

Keep well away from your vehicle and the moving traffic.

5 Call for help

Use an emergency phone or your mobile and say where you are.

KEY FACTS

- Never put a warning triangle on a motorway.
- Don't try even simple repairs on the hard shoulder.
- Marker posts on the hard shoulder show the direction of the nearest emergency phone.
- If you have a disability that stops you leaving the car, stay in it with hazard lights on and call for help.
- To rejoin, build up speed on the hard shoulder and move out only when there is a safe gap.

LAW After stopping in an emergency area, you MUST use the emergency phone before you rejoin.

EASILY CONFUSED

Ordinary road
- Warning triangle 45 m behind
- If it is safe to place it

VS

Motorway
- No warning triangle
- Wait behind the barrier

HOW IT SHOWS UP ON THE TEST

Q1 You break down on a motorway and stop on the hard shoulder. Where should you and your passengers wait?

- **A Behind the barrier, away from the traffic** ✓
- B In the car, to keep warm and dry
- C On the hard shoulder behind the car
- D In front of the car to warn traffic

Why: Get out by the left-hand doors and wait well away from the traffic, behind the barrier if there is one.

TRAPS

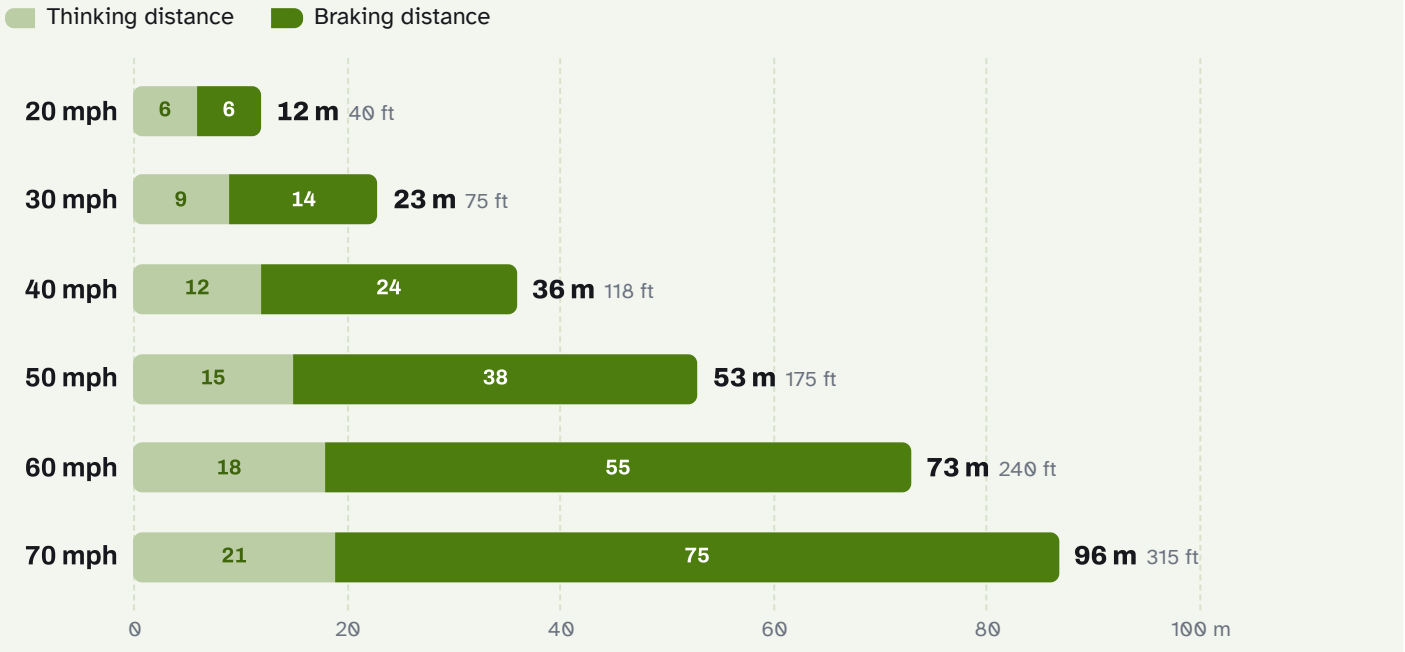
- No warning triangles on a motorway.
- Leave the car by the left-hand doors, away from the traffic.
- On a smart motorway with no hard shoulder, aim for an emergency area instead.

SOURCES The Highway Code, Rules 275 to 278 (Breakdowns) · The Highway Code, Rules 253 to 274 (Motorways)

Stopping Distances

WHAT IT IS The distance your car travels from the moment you see a hazard until it stops: thinking distance plus braking distance.

TYPICAL STOPPING DISTANCES ON A DRY ROAD



KEY FACTS

- Overall stopping distance = thinking distance + braking distance.
- The figures are a general guide: they depend on your attention, the road surface, the weather and your vehicle.
- On faster roads and in tunnels, leave at least a two-second gap to the vehicle in front.
- On wet roads, at least double that gap: stopping distances are at least double.
- On icy roads, stopping distances can be up to ten times longer than on dry roads.

EASILY CONFUSED

Thinking distance
- Grows in step with your speed
- Longer if you're tired, distracted or have been drinking

VS

Braking distance
- Grows much faster than your speed
- Longer on wet or icy roads and with worn tyres

HOW IT SHOWS UP ON THE TEST

Q1 You're driving at 50 mph on a dry road. What is the typical overall stopping distance?

A 23 metres (75 feet)
B 36 metres (118 feet)
C 53 metres (175 feet) ✓
D 96 metres (315 feet)

Why: At 50 mph: 15 m thinking + 38 m braking = 53 m (175 feet).

Q2 The road is wet. How much space should you leave to the vehicle in front, compared with a dry road?

A The same gap
B At least double the gap ✓
C Half the gap
D One extra car length

Why: Stopping distances at least double in the wet, so the two-second gap becomes at least four seconds.

TRAPS

Don't confuse braking distance with overall stopping distance: add the thinking distance.

The table is for good conditions. Wet roads, ice, worn tyres or a tired driver all make it longer.

Double the speed is far more than double the distance: 30 mph is 23 m, 60 mph is 73 m.

SOURCES The Highway Code, Rule 126 · The Highway Code, Rule 227 (Wet weather) · The Highway Code, Rule 230 (Icy and snowy weather)

Following Distance: the Two-Second Rule

WHAT IT IS Leave enough space to stop safely if the vehicle in front brakes suddenly. Measure it in seconds, so it grows with your speed.

THE GAP TO THE VEHICLE IN FRONT

2 s

Dry roads: the minimum

On faster roads and in tunnels

4 s

Wet roads: at least double

Tyres grip less and spray hides the road

Up to 10×

Icy roads

Stopping distances can be up to ten times longer

KEY FACTS

- On faster roads and in tunnels, leave at least a two-second gap to the vehicle in front.
- On wet roads, at least double the gap. On icy roads, leave much more.
- Measure it: note when the vehicle ahead passes a fixed point, such as a sign, and count two seconds.
- Reach that point within two seconds? You are too close: drop back.
- If someone overtakes and pulls into the gap in front, drop back to keep a two-second gap.

EASILY CONFUSED

Two-second gap

- A time, not a distance
- Grows with your speed by itself

VS

Stopping distance

- Metres needed to stop
- Grows much faster than your speed

HOW IT SHOWS UP ON THE TEST

Q1 In good conditions, what is the minimum gap you should leave on a fast road?

- A **2 seconds** ✓
- B 1 second
- C 4 seconds
- D 10 seconds

Why: On faster roads, leave at least two seconds in good conditions, and at least double that on wet roads.

TRAPS

Two seconds is the minimum on dry roads, not a target.

Wet road? Make it at least four seconds.

Being tailgated? Don't speed up to get away from them: keep your gap ahead.

SOURCES The Highway Code, Rule 126 (Stopping distances) · The Highway Code, Rules 227 to 231 (Driving in adverse weather) · The Highway Code, Rule 168 (Being overtaken) · The Highway Code, Rule 235 (Fog)

Wet Roads & Aquaplaning

WHAT IT IS In the rain your tyres grip less and you see less. Unresponsive steering can mean water is stopping the tyres gripping.

IF YOU AQUAPLANE

1. **Steering goes light**
   A sign the tyres are riding on water instead of the road.
2. **Ease off**
   Lift off the accelerator gently and let the car slow down.
3. **No sudden moves**
   Slow down gradually. Harsh braking or steering can cause a skid.
4. **Keep your distance**
   Keep well back from the vehicle in front.

KEY FACTS

- Stopping distances are at least double on wet roads, so leave at least twice the gap.
- If the steering suddenly feels light, water may be stopping the tyres from gripping: ease off the accelerator.
- Rain and spray from other vehicles make it hard to see and be seen: use dipped headlights in dull weather.
- Watch for spilt diesel: it makes the road surface very slippery.
- After driving through deep water, test your brakes gently at the first safe place.

EASILY CONFUSED

Aquaplaning
- Water stops the tyres gripping
- Steering feels light

VS

Wet brakes after a ford
- Brakes feel weak
- Test them gently to dry them

HOW IT SHOWS UP ON THE TEST

Q1 Your steering suddenly feels very light in heavy rain. What is the most likely cause?

- **A** **Your tyres are losing grip on the water** ✓
- B Your power steering has failed
- C Your tyres are over-inflated
- D Your brakes are overheating

Why: This is aquaplaning: water is stopping the tyres from gripping. Ease off the accelerator and slow down gradually.

TRAPS

> Don't brake hard when aquaplaning: ease off the accelerator.

> Rain alone isn't a reason for fog lights, only very poor visibility is.

> Wet roads need at least double the gap, not just a little more.

SOURCES The Highway Code, Rule 227 (Wet weather) · The Highway Code, Rule 121 (Brakes after driving through water) · The Highway Code, Rule 119 (Skids)

Ice & Snow

WHAT IT IS On ice and snow you have very little grip. Only drive if you must, and then do everything slowly and gently.

DRIVING IN ICE AND SNOW

Clear everything first LAW

Windows, lights and number plates by law. Clear the mirrors and the snow on the roof too.

Slow and gentle

Slow speed, high gear, gentle on the accelerator and brakes, no sudden steering.

Brake before bends

Slow down on the straight, then steer smoothly round.

Signs of ice

Tyres go quiet and the steering feels light.

KEY FACTS

- **LAW** You MUST be able to see: clear all snow and ice from every window before you set off.
- **LAW** Lights MUST be clean and number plates clearly visible.
- Stopping distances on ice can be up to ten times longer than on dry roads.
- Use the highest gear you can, and accelerate and brake very gently.
- Brake on the straight before a bend, then steer smoothly round it.
- Very quiet tyres and light steering can mean you are on ice.

EASILY CONFUSED

On ice	VS	On a wet road
• Tyres almost silent • Stopping distance up to 10×		• Rain and spray make it hard to see • Stopping distance at least 2×

HOW IT SHOWS UP ON THE TEST

Q1 You are driving on an icy road. How can you avoid wheelspin?

- **A Use the highest gear you can** ✓
- B Use first gear and high revs
- C Keep the handbrake partly on
- D Accelerate hard to keep moving

Why: The Highway Code says to drive on ice at a slow speed in as high a gear as possible, and to accelerate and brake very gently.

TRAPS

Clear the whole windscreen, not just a small hole to see through.

On ice use as high a gear as possible, and accelerate very gently.

Brake before the bend, not while you are in it.

SOURCES The Highway Code, Rules 228 to 231 (Icy and snowy weather)

Fog

WHAT IT IS Fog cuts how far you can see, sometimes suddenly. Slow down so you can stop within the distance you can see.

DRIVING IN FOG

Lights LAW

Dipped headlights. Fog lights only when you can't see more than about 100 m.

Speed

Slow enough to stop within the distance you can see.

Distance

Leave a big gap. Don't hang on to the tail lights ahead.

Junctions

Stop, listen for traffic, then go when you are sure it is safe.

KEY FACTS

- **LAW** You MUST use headlights when visibility is seriously reduced, usually when you can't see more than 100 metres.
- **LAW** You MUST NOT use fog lights unless visibility is seriously reduced, and MUST switch them off when it improves.
- Drive slowly enough to stop well within the distance you can see is clear.
- Don't follow the tail lights in front: they give a false sense of safety.
- At junctions with a poor view, stop and listen for traffic, then go when you are sure it is safe.

EASILY CONFUSED

Fog lights on	VS	Fog lights off
• Visibility under about 100 m • Visibility seriously reduced		• As soon as visibility improves • They dazzle and hide brake lights

HOW IT SHOWS UP ON THE TEST

Q1 When must you switch off your rear fog lights?

- **A When visibility improves** ✓
- B When you enter a 30 mph area
- C Only at the end of your journey
- D When it gets dark

Why: Fog lights must be switched off as soon as visibility improves, because they dazzle drivers behind and can hide your brake lights.

TRAPS

> Fog can be patchy: a clear stretch can suddenly turn thick again.

> The tail lights ahead don't show you a safe gap.

> Fog lights left on after the fog clears dazzle drivers and hide your brake lights.

SOURCES The Highway Code, Rules 234 to 236 (Fog) · The Highway Code, Rule 226 (Visibility)

Windy Weather

WHAT IT IS Strong winds can push vehicles and riders off course, especially in gusts and on exposed roads.

WHERE WIND CATCHES YOU OUT

Open roads

Exposed stretches with nothing to block a crosswind.

Bridges

Passing bridges can expose you to strong gusts.

Gaps in hedges

Passing a gap in a hedge can let a strong gust hit you.

Passing large vehicles

The air around them can push smaller vehicles and riders.

KEY FACTS

- High-sided vehicles are most affected, but gusts can also push cars, cyclists, motorcyclists and horse riders.
- Expect sudden gusts on exposed open roads, when passing bridges and at gaps in hedges.
- Give cyclists, motorcyclists and horse riders extra room: they may be blown into your path.
- Keep well back from motorcyclists overtaking a high-sided vehicle in strong wind.

EASILY CONFUSED

Passing a lorry in wind

- Turbulence can push you off course
- Motorcyclists are hit hardest

VS

Passing a cyclist in wind

- They may wobble or be blown out
- Give them more room

HOW IT SHOWS UP ON THE TEST

Q1 It is very windy. You are about to overtake a cyclist. What should you do?

- **A Allow extra room** ✓
- B Overtake close and quickly
- C Sound your horn as you pass
- D Stay right behind them

Why: A gust can push a cyclist into your path, so leave extra room when you overtake.

TRAPS

Gaps in hedges and passing bridges can bring sudden strong gusts.

Wind affects cars too, not just lorries and vans.

Motorcyclists overtaking a lorry can be hit by turbulence: keep well back.

SOURCES The Highway Code, Rules 232 and 233 (Windy weather) · The Highway Code, Rules 163 and 212 (Extra space in high winds)

Hills, Gears & Coasting

WHAT IT IS Hills change how your car speeds up and slows down. Use the right gear, and don't coast.

HILLS AND GEARS

Going downhill

Use a lower gear so the engine helps you hold your speed.

Going uphill

If you are slow, use a climbing lane if there is one so others can pass.

Coasting

No engine braking and less control. Keep the car in gear.

Narrow hill roads

Give way to vehicles coming uphill when you can.

KEY FACTS

- Coasting means rolling in neutral or with the clutch pressed down. Avoid it.
- When you coast you lose engine braking, so you speed up quickly downhill and have less control.
- Before a long downhill slope, select a lower gear so engine braking helps control your speed.
- Parking uphill: turn the wheels away from the kerb. Downhill: turn them towards it.
- On single-track roads, give way to vehicles coming uphill whenever you can.

EASILY CONFUSED

Parked facing uphill
- Wheels turned away from the kerb
- Handbrake on, a forward gear

VS

Parked facing downhill
- Wheels turned towards the kerb
- Handbrake on, reverse gear

HOW IT SHOWS UP ON THE TEST

Q1 Why is coasting downhill dangerous?

- **A You lose engine braking** ✓
- B It uses more fuel
- C The brakes stop working
- D The steering locks

Why: Coasting removes engine braking, so the car speeds up quickly downhill and you have less control.

TRAPS

Coasting downhill: speed builds quickly and heavy use of the footbrake can make it less effective.

Uphill parking: forward gear, wheels away from the kerb. Downhill: reverse gear, wheels towards it.

On narrow hill roads, the vehicle coming uphill usually gets priority.

SOURCES The Highway Code, Rule 122 (Coasting) · The Highway Code, Rule 252 (Parking on hills) · The Highway Code, Rule 155 (Single-track roads) · The Highway Code, Rule 160 (Once moving) · The Highway Code, Rule 139 (Climbing and crawler lanes)

Skids & ABS

WHAT IT IS A skid happens when the tyres lose grip. ABS helps you keep steering control, but don't assume it will stop you sooner.

SKIDS AND SAFETY SYSTEMS

Rear skid

Release the brake or ease off the accelerator, and steer the same way as the skid.

ABS

Stops the wheels locking when you brake hard, so you can still steer.

Emergency stop (no ABS)

Brake immediately, but try not to lock the wheels: locked wheels can mean loss of control.

Speed still matters

Skids are often caused by driving too fast for the road conditions.

KEY FACTS

- Skids are usually caused by harsh braking, accelerating or steering, or by going too fast for the conditions.
- If the rear of the car skids to the right, steer immediately to the right to recover.
- In a skid, remove the cause: release the brake pedal fully or ease off the accelerator.
- With ABS, brake firmly in an emergency and keep your foot down: you can still steer.
- Don't assume a car with ABS will stop in a shorter distance.

EASILY CONFUSED

ABS	VS	Without ABS
Works when you brake hard		Harsh braking can lock the wheels
Lets you steer while braking		Locked wheels can cause loss of control

HOW IT SHOWS UP ON THE TEST

Q1 The rear of your car skids to the right. What should you do?

- **A Steer to the right** ✓
- B Steer to the left
- C Brake hard
- D Pull the handbrake

Why: Release the brake or ease off the accelerator, and steer in the direction of the skid: if the rear skids right, steer right.

TRAPS

> Don't assume ABS will stop you in a shorter distance.

> With ABS in an emergency, brake firmly and don't release until you have slowed down.

> In a skid, release the brake pedal fully or ease off the accelerator.

SOURCES The Highway Code, Rules 118 to 120 (Emergency braking, skids and ABS)

Driving at Night & Dazzle

WHAT IT IS At night you see less and others see you less. Use your lights well and never dazzle other road users.

SEEING AND BEING SEEN AT NIGHT

Main beam

On unlit roads at night, as long as it won't dazzle anyone ahead or coming towards you.

Dipped beam

At night in built-up areas and in dull daytime weather.

Dazzled

Slow down, and stop if you need to.

Clean glass LAW

Windscreen and windows MUST be kept clean and free from obstructions.

KEY FACTS

- If oncoming headlights dazzle you, slow down and stop if you need to.
- **LAW** You MUST NOT use any lights in a way that would dazzle or cause discomfort to other road users.
- When overtaking at night, stay on dipped beam until you are level, then use main beam if needed.
- Drive at a speed that lets you stop within the distance your lights show to be clear.
- Pedestrians, cyclists and horse riders are much harder to see after dark.

EASILY CONFUSED

Main beam
- Unlit roads at night
- Never if it would dazzle

VS

Dipped beam
- Built-up areas at night
- Also in dull daytime weather

HOW IT SHOWS UP ON THE TEST

Q1 You are dazzled by the headlights of an oncoming vehicle. What should you do?

- **A Slow down, and stop if you need to** ✓
- B Flash your headlights at them
- C Switch to main beam
- D Look straight at their lights

Why: If you are dazzled, slow down and if necessary stop until you can see properly again.

TRAPS

Don't answer dazzle with your own main beam.

At night other road users are harder to see: reduce your speed.

Avoid long journeys between midnight and 6 am, when alertness is at its lowest.

SOURCES The Highway Code, Rules 113 to 116 (Lighting requirements) · The Highway Code, Rule 125 (Speed limits) · The Highway Code, Rule 91 (Tiredness) · The Highway Code, Annex 6 (Vehicle maintenance, safety and security)

Alertness, Distractions & Phones

WHAT IT IS Safe driving needs concentration at all times. Phones, loud music, eating, smoking and arguing can all distract you.

A HAND-HELD PHONE AT THE WHEEL COSTS

£200
Fixed penalty
Up to £1,000 if it goes to court

6 points
On your licence
For every hand-held phone offence

2 years
New drivers
6 points within 2 years of passing and you lose your licence

KEY FACTS

LAW You MUST NOT use a hand-held phone or similar device while driving, even when stopped at lights or in a queue.

- You may call 999 or 112 on a hand-held phone in a real emergency, if it is unsafe or impractical to stop.

LAW You MUST exercise proper control of your vehicle at all times, even when using a hands-free phone.

- It's far safer not to use any phone while driving: find a safe place to stop first, or use voicemail.
- Loud music, eating, smoking and arguing passengers can all distract you.

EASILY CONFUSED

Hand-held phone	VS	Hands-free phone
• Illegal while driving • Even stopped at lights or in a queue		• Legal, but still a distraction • You must stay in proper control

HOW IT SHOWS UP ON THE TEST

Q1 When may you use a hand-held mobile phone while driving?

- **A To call 999 in an emergency when it is unsafe to stop** ✓
- B When you are stopped at traffic lights
- C When you are queuing in slow traffic
- D To check your sat nav for a moment

Why: You can call 999 or 112 in a genuine emergency if it's unsafe or impractical to stop. Being stopped in traffic still counts as driving.

TRAPS

Stopped at the lights still counts as driving.

Hands-free is legal, but it is not risk-free.

New drivers: one phone offence (6 points) is enough to lose your licence.

SOURCES The Highway Code, Rules 148 to 150 (Driving and distractions) · GOV.UK, Using mobile phones when driving: the law

Tiredness

WHAT IT IS Driving when you are tired greatly increases your risk of a collision. Don't start a journey tired, and plan regular breaks.

PLAN YOUR JOURNEY AROUND THESE NUMBERS

2 hours
Recommended break interval
Then take a break of at least 15 minutes

15 min
Minimum break
Recommended after every 2 hours of driving

0–6 am
Riskiest hours
You are naturally least alert

KEY FACTS

- Plan a break of at least 15 minutes after every 2 hours of driving.
- Avoid long journeys between midnight and 6 am, when you are naturally least alert.
- If you feel sleepy, stop in a safe place: not on a motorway hard shoulder or in an emergency area.
- Don't begin a journey if you are tired. Get enough sleep before a long journey.
- Motorway driving can make you sleepy: use service areas to take breaks.

EASILY CONFUSED

What works	VS	Where not to stop
• Stop in a safe place • Plan breaks: 15 min every 2 hours	VS	• Motorway hard shoulder • Emergency area

HOW IT SHOWS UP ON THE TEST

Q1 You feel sleepy while driving on a motorway. What should you do?

- **A Leave at the next exit and stop somewhere safe** ✓
- B Stop on the hard shoulder for a nap
- C Open the window and keep going
- D Turn the radio up loud

Why: Leave the motorway and stop in a safe place to rest. The hard shoulder is for emergencies only.

TRAPS

- The hard shoulder is not a place to rest.
- An emergency area isn't a place to rest either: stop somewhere safe.
- Long night journeys are riskiest between midnight and 6 am.

SOURCES The Highway Code, Rule 91 (Fitness to drive: tiredness) · The Highway Code, Rule 262 (Motorways: tiredness)

Map 5.02 · v0.1.0 · Checked against The Highway Code on 12 Oct 2026

Alcohol & the Law

WHAT IT IS Alcohol slows your reactions and makes you overconfident. The only safe amount before driving is none.

LEGAL LIMITS IN ENGLAND AND WALES

35 µg	80 mg	107 mg
Per 100 ml of breath	Per 100 ml of blood	Per 100 ml of urine

KEY FACTS

LAW You MUST NOT drive with alcohol in your body above the legal limit.

- Alcohol slows reactions, affects judgement of speed and distance, and gives false confidence.
- Any amount of alcohol affects your driving, so the best choice is not to drink at all if you plan to drive.
- Alcohol can still be in your body the next morning.
- Drink-driving can mean at least a 1-year ban, an unlimited fine and up to 6 months in prison.

In Scotland: Scotland's limits are lower: 22 µg per 100 ml of breath, 50 mg per 100 ml of blood, 67 mg per 100 ml of urine.

In England and Wales: A lower limit for England and Wales has been proposed but was not law when this map was written. Check before your test.

EASILY CONFUSED

England and Wales	VS	Scotland
• 35 µg per 100 ml of breath • 80 mg per 100 ml of blood		• 22 µg per 100 ml of breath • 50 mg per 100 ml of blood

HOW IT SHOWS UP ON THE TEST

Q1 You are going to drive this evening. How much alcohol is safe to drink?

- **A None at all ✓**
- B One pint of beer
- C Two small glasses of wine
- D Any amount, if you eat a meal

Why: Alcohol affects everyone differently, so there is no safe amount. The safest choice is not to drink at all if you are driving.

TRAPS

Even below the legal limit, alcohol reduces your driving ability.

You can still be over the limit the morning after.

Scotland's limit is lower than England and Wales.

SOURCES The Highway Code, Rule 95 (Alcohol) · GOV.UK, The drink drive limit · GOV.UK, Drink-driving penalties · GOV.UK, Road Safety Strategy announcement (7 January 2026)

Drugs & Medicines

WHAT IT IS Illegal drugs and some medicines can make you unsafe to drive. Driving while impaired by either is against the law.

BEFORE YOU DRIVE

Illegal drugs LAW

Never drive after taking them. Their effects are unpredictable.

Medicines

Ask your doctor or pharmacist. Don't drive if you're told you may be impaired.

Not sure?

Ask your doctor or pharmacist before you drive.

Roadside tests

The police can test you for drugs at the roadside.

KEY FACTS

- **LAW** You MUST NOT drive under the influence of drugs or medicine.
- **LAW** You MUST NOT drive with certain drugs in your blood above set limits, even if you feel fine.
- Even over-the-counter medicines can affect your driving. Read the label to see if they may affect it.
- Check with your doctor or pharmacist, and don't drive if you're advised you may be impaired.
- Drug-driving penalties include at least a 1-year ban, an unlimited fine and a criminal record.

EASILY CONFUSED

Illegal drugs	VS	Medicines
• Never drive after taking them • Illegal above very low limits		• Can be fine to drive on • Only if they don't impair you

HOW IT SHOWS UP ON THE TEST

Q1 Your doctor has prescribed a new medicine. What should you do before you drive?

- **A Check if it is safe to drive while taking it** ✓
- B Drive only short distances
- C Drink a strong coffee first
- D Drive only in daylight

Why: Some medicines affect your driving. Read the label, check with your doctor or pharmacist, and don't drive if you're advised you may be impaired.

TRAPS

Legal medicines can still make your driving illegal if they impair you.

Over-the-counter medicines count too: if they make you unfit to drive, it's illegal.

Feeling fine doesn't mean you are under the drug-driving limit.

SOURCES The Highway Code, Rule 96 (Drugs and medicine) · GOV.UK, Drugs and driving: the law · The Highway Code, Annex 8 (Safety code for new drivers)

Attitude: Following Too Close & Courtesy

WHAT IT IS Be considerate and patient with all road users. Anyone can make a mistake, so don't react if someone drives badly.

CALM, PATIENT DRIVING

Keep your distance

At least two seconds on fast roads, more in the wet. Never drive close to intimidate.

Stay calm

Don't answer bad driving with more bad driving. Let it go.

Be patient

Learners and older drivers may need more time. Give it to them.

Let others in

Make room for merging traffic, and don't block junctions.

KEY FACTS

- Driving too close to the vehicle in front (tailgating) is dangerous and intimidating.
- If someone pulls out in front of you, hold back and let them get clear. Don't drive close to make a point.
- If another driver behaves badly, don't react. Pull over and calm down if you need to.
- Be patient with learner, young and older drivers: anyone can make a mistake.
- When someone overtakes you, keep a steady course and speed, slowing down if needed to let them pass.

EASILY CONFUSED

Flashing headlights

- Only means "I am here"
- Never assume it invites you to go

VS

Holding back to let them out

- Fine, if it is safe
- Let them decide when to go

HOW IT SHOWS UP ON THE TEST

Q1 A driver pulls out of a junction in front of you, so you have to brake. What should you do?

- **A Slow down and stay calm** ✓
- B Flash your lights to show your annoyance
- C Sound your horn and follow closely
- D Overtake them as soon as you can

Why: Hold back and let them get clear. Reacting angrily makes the situation more dangerous for everyone.

TRAPS

Courtesy doesn't mean waving people on: let them decide when it is safe.

Speeding up or driving unpredictably while someone is overtaking you is dangerous.

Don't flash your headlights or sound your horn to intimidate or show annoyance.

SOURCES

The Highway Code, Rule 147 (Be considerate) · The Highway Code, Rule 126 (Stopping distances) · The Highway Code, Rule 168 (Being overtaken) · The Highway Code, Rules 110 and 111 (Flashing headlights) · The Highway Code, Rules 216 and 217 (Older, learner and inexperienced drivers) · The Highway Code, Rules 134 and 151 (Merging in turn, slow-moving traffic)

Pedestrians: Children, Older & Disabled People

WHAT IT IS Pedestrians are among the road users most at risk, in particular children, older adults and disabled people.

PEDESTRIANS WHO NEED EXTRA CARE

Children

They may step into the road unexpectedly, for example from between parked cars.

Older people

May be slower and may misjudge your speed.

White cane

The person may be blind or partially sighted.

White cane with a red band

The person may be deafblind: they may not see or hear you.

Guide dogs

Guide dog: blind or partially sighted. Red and white harness: may be deafblind.

Wheelchairs and scooters

Small, slow vehicles (up to 8 mph). On most roads they have no warning beacon.

KEY FACTS

- Watch for children near schools, bus stops, parked cars and ice cream vans: they may run into the road.
- Older pedestrians may need more time to cross and may not be able to judge your speed.
- Someone with a white cane may be blind or partially sighted. A white cane with a red band: they may be deafblind.
- Powered wheelchairs and mobility scooters can travel at up to 8 mph on the road: give them room.
- Give way to pedestrians crossing or waiting to cross the road you are turning into or out of.

EASILY CONFUSED

White cane
- Blind or partially sighted
- May not see you

VS

White cane with a red band
- May be deafblind
- May not see or hear you

HOW IT SHOWS UP ON THE TEST

Q1 You see a pedestrian with a white cane with a red band. What does this mean?

- **A They may be deaf and blind** ✓
- B They are partially sighted only
- C They are an older person
- D They are training a guide dog

Why: A white cane with a red band means the person may be deafblind, so they may not see you or hear your horn.

TRAPS

A deafblind person may not see or hear your signals, including your horn.

Children can appear from behind parked cars, buses and ice cream vans.

Where there is no pavement, people may walk in the road: give them room.

SOURCES The Highway Code, Rules 204 to 210 (Road users requiring extra care) · The Highway Code, Rule 220 (Powered wheelchairs and mobility scooters) · The Highway Code, Rule 152 (Residential streets)

Map 5.06 · v0.1.0 · Checked against The Highway Code on 12 Oct 2026

Cyclists: Passing, Lanes & the Dutch Reach

WHAT IT IS Cyclists are among the road users most at risk and are often hard to see. Give them space, look out for them, and open doors with care.

THREE THINGS TO REMEMBER

1.5 m

Minimum gap at up to 30 mph

Leave more space at higher speeds

2 abreast

Cyclists may ride side by side

Can be safer for groups on narrow or quiet roads

Far hand

The Dutch reach: open your door with it

It makes you turn and look behind

KEY FACTS

- When passing a cyclist, leave at least 1.5 metres at speeds up to 30 mph, and more at higher speeds.
- If you can't leave that much space, wait behind until you can.
- Don't cut across cyclists going straight ahead when you turn or change lane.
- Cyclists may ride in the middle of the lane on quiet roads, in slow traffic and at junctions, so they can be seen.
- Open your car door with the hand furthest from it (the "Dutch reach"), so you turn and look for cyclists.

EASILY CONFUSED

Cyclist in the middle of the lane

- Makes them easier to see
- Allowed on quiet roads and at junctions

VS

Cyclist near the side of the road

- Still leave at least 1.5 m up to 30 mph
- May swerve round drains or potholes

HOW IT SHOWS UP ON THE TEST

Q1 You are passing a cyclist on a 30 mph road. What is the minimum space you should leave?

- **A 1.5 metres** ✓
- B 0.5 metres
- C 1 metre
- D 3 metres

Why: Leave at least 1.5 metres at speeds up to 30 mph, and more when you are going faster.

TRAPS

1.5 m is the minimum up to 30 mph, not the gap for every speed.

Riding two abreast is allowed: don't squeeze past.

At an advanced stop line, stop at the first white line and leave the cyclists' box clear.

SOURCES The Highway Code, Rules 163, 212 and 213 (Overtaking cyclists) · The Highway Code, Rule 239 (Opening doors) · The Highway Code, Rule H3 · The Highway Code, Rule 178 (Advanced stop lines)

Motorcyclists

WHAT IT IS Motorcyclists are hard to see, especially at junctions, and may be closer and faster than you think. Look out for them and give them room.

LOOK OUT FOR MOTORCYCLISTS

At junctions

They may be closer and faster than you think. Look carefully.

Filtering

Bikes may pass between lanes of slow traffic. Check mirrors.

Shoulder checks

A rider looking back may be about to move. Give them space.

Bad road surfaces

Potholes and drain covers can make a rider swerve.

KEY FACTS

- Motorcyclists are hard to see at junctions, at roundabouts and when filtering: look carefully.
- They may filter between lanes of slow or stopped traffic: check your mirrors before you change lane.
- A rider looking over their shoulder may be about to turn or change lane: give them time.
- Riders may swerve suddenly to avoid potholes, drain covers or slippery patches.
- In strong wind, keep well back from motorcyclists overtaking large vehicles.

EASILY CONFUSED

Rider looks over shoulder
- About to move or turn
- Give them time and space

VS

Indicator flashing
- May have been left on
- Wait to see what they do

HOW IT SHOWS UP ON THE TEST

Q1 Why should you look carefully for motorcyclists at junctions?

- **A They are hard to see and may be faster than you think** ✓
- B They always have priority
- C They must stop at every junction
- D They are not allowed to filter

Why: Motorcycles are small and easy to miss. They may be closer and faster than you expect, so look carefully before you pull out.

TRAPS

Motorcyclists are hard to see: check mirrors and blind spots carefully before you turn or pull out.

Filtering motorcyclists can pass on either side.

A rider may swerve for a drain cover or pothole: leave room.

SOURCES The Highway Code, Rules 211 to 213 (Motorcyclists and cyclists) · The Highway Code, Rule 233 (Windy weather) · The Highway Code, Rule 104 (Signals) · The Highway Code, Rule 151 (Slow-moving traffic)

Horse Riders & Animals

WHAT IT IS Horses can be frightened by noise and speed. Pass them slowly and widely, and take care with any animals on the road.

PASSING A HORSE

10 mph

Maximum speed

Pass slowly and be ready to stop

2 m

Minimum space

Leave more if you can, and pass wide

KEY FACTS

- Pass horse riders and horse-drawn vehicles at no more than 10 mph, leaving at least 2 metres.
- Don't sound your horn or rev your engine near horses.
- Riders may ride in the centre of the lane on narrow roads, or in double file to escort a young horse or rider.
- At a roundabout, a horse rider may keep to the left lane and signal right if they are going round.
- If a herd of animals blocks the road, stop, switch off your engine and wait until they have gone.

EASILY CONFUSED

Horse rider at a roundabout

- Stays in the left lane
- Signals right to go round

VS

Car at a roundabout

- Usually uses the right lane
- Signals right to go round

HOW IT SHOWS UP ON THE TEST

Q1 How should you pass a horse rider?

- **A** **At no more than 10 mph, leaving at least 2 metres** ✓
- B Quickly, to spend less time near the horse
- C At 20 mph, leaving 1 metre
- D After sounding your horn to warn them

Why: Pass slowly, at no more than 10 mph, and leave at least 2 metres. Noise and speed can frighten horses.

TRAPS

Never sound your horn to warn a horse rider: it can frighten the horse.

At a roundabout, a rider in the left lane may be going all the way round.

Herd of animals on the road? Stop and switch off your engine.

SOURCES The Highway Code, Rules 214 and 215 (Animals and horse riders) · The Highway Code, Rule 186 (Roundabouts: signals and position) · The Highway Code, Rules 163 and 213 (Overtaking, narrow roads)

Large & Emergency Vehicles, Buses, Trams

WHAT IT IS Large vehicles need more room and can't see you easily. Emergency vehicles need you to help them through safely.

SHARING THE ROAD WITH BIG VEHICLES

Blue, red or green lights

Pull over to let them pass when it is safe and legal.

Long vehicles turning

They may need the whole road width to turn. Be ready to stop and wait.

Blind spots

Following a large vehicle? The driver may not see you in their mirrors.

Buses pulling out

Let them out of a stop when you safely can.

Trams

They can't steer round you and can be very quiet.

Stay back

Drop back so you can see past and the driver can see you.

KEY FACTS

- Emergency vehicles with flashing blue, red or green lights, flashing headlights or sirens: let them pass when safe.
- Let them pass while obeying all traffic signs, including red lights, and avoid mounting the kerb.
- Long vehicles may need the whole width of the road to turn at a junction. Be ready to stop and wait.
- If you follow a large vehicle, the driver may not be able to see you in their mirrors. Drop back.
- Give way to buses signalling to pull out from a stop, when it is safe.

EASILY CONFUSED

Blue lights
- Police, fire, ambulance and others
- Pull over when it is safe

VS

Green lights
- Used by a doctor
- Let them pass if you safely can

HOW IT SHOWS UP ON THE TEST

Q1 An ambulance with flashing blue lights is behind you at a red traffic light. What should you do?

- **A Stay where you are, unless you can let it pass safely and legally** ✓
- B Drive through the red light
- C Move into the bus lane at once
- D Get out and wave it past

Why: Help emergency vehicles through, but don't break the law or put anyone at risk. Don't go through a red light.

TRAPS

Making way never means going through a red light or into a bus lane.

Long vehicles may take a different course or straddle lanes to turn: watch for their signals.

Too close behind a large vehicle? The driver may not see you in their mirrors.

SOURCES The Highway Code, Rules 219 to 225 (Other vehicles) · The Highway Code, Rules 164 and 170 (Large vehicles, long vehicles at junctions) · legislation.gov.uk, Road Vehicles Lighting Regulations 1989, reg 11

Vehicle Checks & Tyres

WHAT IT IS You MUST make sure your vehicle is legal and roadworthy. Regular checks of tyres, lights, fluids and warning displays help.

BEFORE A TRIP, THINK POWDER

P · Petrol
Enough fuel or charge for your journey, especially on motorways.

O · Oil
Check fluid levels, including oil, at least weekly. Know your low-fluid warning lights.

W · Water
Engine coolant and screen washer topped up.

D · Damage
Check for fuel leaks and any damage to the fuel cap or tank.

E · Electrics
Lights, indicators, horn and warning lights all working.

R · Rubber
Tyres: tread, pressure, cuts and bulges. Wiper blades too.

KEY FACTS

- **LAW** Car tyres MUST have at least 1.6 mm of tread across the central three-quarters, all the way round.
- **LAW** Tyres MUST be correctly inflated to the maker's specification for the load being carried.
- **LAW** Lights, indicators, reflectors and number plates MUST be kept clean and clear.
- **LAW** Windscreens and windows MUST be kept clean and clear.
- Check tyre pressures when the tyres are cold, using the figures in the handbook.

EASILY CONFUSED

Wrong tyre pressures
- Brakes and steering are affected
- Under-inflated: more fuel used

VS

Uneven tyre wear
- May be a brake or suspension fault
- Or wheels out of alignment

HOW IT SHOWS UP ON THE TEST

Q1 What is the legal minimum tread depth for car tyres?

- **A 1.6 mm** ✓
- B 1 mm
- C 2.5 mm
- D 3 mm

Why: Car tyres must have at least 1.6 mm of tread across the central three-quarters of the tread, all the way round.

TRAPS

1.6 mm is across the central three-quarters, all the way round the tyre.

Check pressures when the tyres are cold.

Good tread isn't enough: tyres should also be free from cuts and other defects.

SOURCES The Highway Code, Annex 6 (Vehicle maintenance, safety and security) · The Highway Code, Rule 97 (Before setting off)

Eco-Safe Driving & the Environment

WHAT IT IS Eco-safe driving means planning ahead and driving smoothly, avoiding unnecessary acceleration and braking. It saves fuel and cuts CO2.

SIMPLE WAYS TO SAVE FUEL

Look well ahead

Ease off early instead of braking hard at the last moment.

Smooth and steady

Gentle acceleration and a steady speed use the least fuel.

Engine off when parked LAW

Don't leave it running unnecessarily while stationary on a public road.

Travel light

Remove roof boxes and unneeded weight. Keep tyres inflated.

KEY FACTS

- Plan ahead so you can avoid harsh braking and sudden acceleration.
- Change up through the gears early, usually by about 2,000 rpm.
- **LAW** You MUST NOT leave your engine running unnecessarily while stopped on a public road.
- Remove roof boxes when not needed: at motorway speeds one can raise fuel use by around 25%.
- Under-inflated tyres and extra weight make the car use more fuel.
- Fuel use rises with speed: at 70 mph a car uses about 10% more fuel than at 60 mph.

EASILY CONFUSED

Eco-safe driving
- Plan ahead, ease off early
- Engine braking in gear

VS

Coasting
- Rolling in neutral or with the clutch down
- Less control, not eco-safe

HOW IT SHOWS UP ON THE TEST

Q1 How can you reduce your fuel consumption?

- **A Plan ahead and avoid harsh braking** ✓
- B Accelerate hard to reach your cruising speed
- C Keep the engine running when parked
- D Stay in lower gears for longer

Why: Planning ahead lets you ease off early instead of braking hard, which saves fuel and is safer.

TRAPS

Coasting reduces your control: engine braking is lost and speed builds quickly downhill.

Leaving the engine running while parked can be an offence, not just a waste.

A roof box left on when empty still costs you fuel.

SOURCES The Highway Code, Rule 123 (The driver and the environment) · The Highway Code, Rule 122 (Coasting) · GOV.UK, Save money on your holiday driving (DfT)

Seat Belts & Child Restraints

WHAT IT IS You must wear a seat belt if one is fitted. The driver is responsible for children under 14; passengers 14 and over for themselves.

WHO WEARS WHAT, AND WHO IS RESPONSIBLE

WHO	FRONT SEAT	REAR SEAT	RESPONSIBLE
Driver	Seat belt	-	Driver
Child under 3	Child seat	Child seat	Driver
Child from 3 to 12, under 135 cm	Child seat	Child seat (a few exceptions)	Driver
Child aged 12 or 13, or taller than 135 cm	Seat belt	Seat belt	Driver
Passenger aged 14 or over	Seat belt	Seat belt	Passenger

Exceptions for children apply only in a few cases, such as some taxis or an unexpected short trip.

KEY FACTS

- **LAW** You MUST wear a seat belt if one is fitted, unless you are exempt.
- **LAW** The driver MUST make sure children under 14 wear a seat belt or the right child restraint.
- **LAW** Children MUST use the correct child restraint until they are 12 years old or 135 cm tall, whichever comes first.
- **LAW** You MUST NOT put a rear-facing baby seat in a seat with an active frontal airbag.
- Passengers aged 14 and over are responsible for wearing their own seat belts.

EASILY CONFUSED

Child under 14
- The driver is responsible
- Belt or child seat

VS

Passenger 14 or over
- Responsible for themselves
- They get the fine

HOW IT SHOWS UP ON THE TEST

Q1 Who is responsible for making sure a 13-year-old passenger wears a seat belt?

- **A The driver** ✓
- B The child
- C The child's parent, even if not in the car
- D The owner of the car

Why: The driver is responsible for passengers under 14. Passengers aged 14 and over are responsible for themselves.

TRAPS

12 years or 135 cm: whichever comes first.

Rear-facing seat in front of an active airbag: never.

A 14-year-old who doesn't wear a belt is fined, not the driver.

SOURCES The Highway Code, Rules 99 to 102 (Seat belts and child restraints) · GOV.UK, Child car seats: the rules · GOV.UK, Seat belts: the law

Loading & Towing

WHAT IT IS A heavy load or a trailer changes how your car brakes, steers and handles. Load it safely and know your limits.

TOWING IN NUMBERS

3,500 kg
Maximum trailer weight on a car licence
Licence from 1 Jan 1997: trailer up to 3,500 kg MAM

50 mph
Single carriageways
When towing a caravan or trailer

60 mph
Dual carriageways and motorways
Never the right lane on 3 or more lanes

KEY FACTS

- **LAW** Your load MUST be secure and MUST NOT stick out dangerously.
- **LAW** You MUST NOT overload your car or trailer: check the handbook for the maximum weights.
- With a heavy load you may need to change the tyre pressures and headlight aim.
- If a trailer or caravan starts to snake, ease off the accelerator and slow down gently.
- Towing: 50 mph on single carriageways, 60 mph on dual carriageways and motorways.

EASILY CONFUSED

Trailer snaking
- Ease off the accelerator
- Slow down gently, no harsh braking

VS

Car skidding
- Release the brake or ease off the accelerator
- Steer the way the rear is sliding

HOW IT SHOWS UP ON THE TEST

Q1 Your caravan starts to snake from side to side. What should you do?

- **A Ease off the accelerator and slow down gently** ✓
- B Brake hard straight away
- C Speed up to straighten it
- D Steer sharply the other way

Why: Ease off the accelerator and reduce speed gently until the caravan is under control again.

TRAPS

> Speeding up doesn't cure snaking: slowing down gently does.

> Towing on a motorway with 3 or more lanes: never the right-hand lane.

> A load sticking out dangerously is illegal, not just risky.

SOURCES The Highway Code, Rule 98 (Vehicle towing and loading) · The Highway Code, Rule 124 (Speed limits) · GOV.UK, Towing with a car · The Highway Code, Rule 119 (Skids) · The Highway Code, Annex 6 (Tyres: inflate for the load being carried)

Documents: Licence, Insurance, MOT & Tax

WHAT IT IS To drive legally you need a valid licence, insurance, vehicle tax and, for older cars, an MOT certificate.

THE PAPERS BEHIND EVERY CAR

Driving licence LAW

Must be valid for the vehicle you drive. Keep your address up to date.

Insurance LAW

At least third-party cover to drive on a public road.

MOT LAW

First at 3 years old, then every year. Checks road safety and environmental standards.

Vehicle tax LAW

Needed to drive or keep the car on a public road.

V5C logbook LAW

Shows the registered keeper. Tell DVLA about any changes.

SORN LAW

Declare it if you keep an untaxed vehicle off the road.

KEY FACTS

- **LAW** You MUST have at least third-party insurance to drive on a public road.
- **LAW** A car MUST normally have its first MOT at 3 years old, then every year.
- **LAW** A vehicle MUST be taxed to be driven or kept on a public road. With a SORN, it MUST be kept off the road.
- The V5C registration certificate shows the registered keeper, not necessarily the owner.
- **LAW** You MUST tell DVLA when you buy or sell a vehicle, or change your name or address.

EASILY CONFUSED

Third party only	VS	Comprehensive
The legal minimum		Covers others and your own car
Covers damage to others, not your car		Costs more, covers more

HOW IT SHOWS UP ON THE TEST

Q1 When does a car need its first MOT?

- **A When it is 3 years old** ✓
- B When it is 1 year old
- C When it is 4 years old
- D After 30,000 miles

Why: In Great Britain a car needs its first MOT when it is 3 years old, and then every year.

TRAPS

- The V5C shows the registered keeper. It isn't proof of ownership.
- Third-party cover doesn't pay for damage to your own car.
- An MOT doesn't mean the car stays roadworthy all year: keep checking it.

SOURCES The Highway Code, Annex 3 (Motor vehicle documentation and learner driver requirements) · GOV.UK, Getting an MOT · GOV.UK, The redesigned vehicle registration certificate (speech) · GOV.UK, Register your vehicle as off the road (SORN)

Learner & New Driver Rules

WHAT IT IS Learners must meet extra rules while they learn, and new drivers face a lower points limit for their first 2 years.

LEARNER AND NEW DRIVER RULES

Supervisor LAW

Aged 21 or over, with a full licence for 3 years or more.

L or D plates LAW

Front and back of the car while you are learning.

Motorways LAW

Only with an approved driving instructor in a dual-control car.

Insurance LAW

You must be insured to drive the car you learn in.

P plates

Optional after you pass. They show you are a new driver.

6 points in 2 years

A new driver who reaches 6 points loses their licence.

KEY FACTS

- **LAW** Your supervisor MUST be at least 21 and have held a full licence for that type of car for at least 3 years.
- **LAW** L plates (or D plates in Wales) MUST be shown on the front and back of the car.
- **LAW** Learners MUST NOT drive on motorways unless with an approved driving instructor in a dual-control car.
- **LAW** A supervisor MUST NOT use a hand-held phone while supervising: the phone law applies to them too.
- New drivers who get 6 or more points within 2 years of passing lose their licence.

In Wales: In Wales learners can show D plates instead of L plates.

EASILY CONFUSED

L plates	vs	P plates
Required while learning		Optional after you pass
D plates can be used in Wales		Show you are a new driver

HOW IT SHOWS UP ON THE TEST

Q1 Who may supervise a learner driver in a car?

- **A Someone aged 21+ who has held a full licence for 3 years** ✓
- B Any full licence holder aged 18 or over
- C Someone aged 21+ who has held a licence for 1 year
- D Anyone who is insured to drive the car

Why: A supervisor must be at least 21 and have held a full licence for that type of vehicle for at least 3 years.

TRAPS

A learner can't go on a motorway with a parent, only with an instructor.

D plates are the Welsh version of L plates.

New drivers: 6 points within 2 years means a new provisional licence and passing theory and practical tests again.

SOURCES GOV.UK, Driving lessons and learning to drive · The Highway Code, Annex 3 (Learner drivers) · GOV.UK, New drivers: penalty points · GOV.UK, Using mobile phones when driving: the law · The Highway Code, Rule 253 (Motorways: prohibited vehicles)

Penalties & Points

WHAT IT IS Penalty points (endorsements) go on your driving record when you break certain traffic laws. Too many and you lose your licence.

POINTS IN NUMBERS

12 points

Within 3 years

You can be banned from driving

6 points

New drivers, within 2 years

Your licence is revoked

4 or 11 yrs

How long points stay on record

Depends on the offence

KEY FACTS

- If you get 12 or more points within 3 years, you can be banned from driving.
- New drivers: 6 or more points within 2 years of passing and your licence is revoked.
- Points stay on your driving record for 4 or 11 years, depending on the offence.
- Using a hand-held phone while driving: £200 and 6 points.
- Speeding usually means at least 3 points, and can mean up to 6.

EASILY CONFUSED

Licence revoked (new driver)

- Back to a provisional licence
- Pass theory and practical again

VS

Disqualified (ban)

- Can't drive for a set time
- Set by a court

HOW IT SHOWS UP ON THE TEST

Q1 You passed your test a year ago. How many points would get your licence revoked?

- A 6 ✓
- B 3
- C 9
- D 12

Why: If you get 6 or more points within 2 years of passing your test, your licence is revoked.

TRAPS

12 points is the limit for experienced drivers. New drivers lose their licence at 6.

Drink-driving endorsements stay on your record for 11 years.

Points are counted over 3 years, not one calendar year.

SOURCES GOV.UK, Penalty points (endorsements) · GOV.UK, New drivers: penalty points · GOV.UK, Using mobile phones when driving: the law

Breakdowns & Warning Triangles

WHAT IT IS If you break down, think first about other road users. Get off the road if you can and warn traffic.

IF YOU BREAK DOWN ON AN ORDINARY ROAD

1 Get off the road

Get your vehicle off the road if possible, ideally a place designed for parking or a lay-by.

2 Hazard lights on

If your car is blocking traffic. Sidelights too after dark.

3 Stand clear

Don't stand between your car and oncoming traffic, or where you hide its lights at night.

4 Triangle 45 m back

On the same side of the road. Never on a motorway.

5 Call for help

Stay off the road and well away from your car while you wait.

KEY FACTS

- Put a warning triangle at least 45 metres behind your car, on the same side of the road.
- Never use a warning triangle on a motorway.
- Don't stand between your car and oncoming traffic.
- Wear light-coloured or fluorescent clothing in daylight, and reflective clothing at night or in poor visibility.
- Keep your sidelights on if it is dark or visibility is poor.

EASILY CONFUSED

Hazard warning lights
- On the car itself
- When it is blocking traffic

VS

Warning triangle
- 45 m behind the car
- Not on motorways

HOW IT SHOWS UP ON THE TEST

Q1 How far behind your broken-down car should you put a warning triangle on an ordinary road?

- **A At least 45 metres** ✓
- B At least 5 metres
- C At least 15 metres
- D At least 100 metres

Why: Place it at least 45 metres behind, on the same side of the road. Never use one on a motorway.

TRAPS

No warning triangles on motorways.

At night or in poor visibility, don't stand where you hide your lights from drivers behind.

45 m, on the same side of the road as your car.

SOURCES The Highway Code, Rule 276 (Breakdowns) · The Highway Code, Rule 275 (Place of relative safety)

At the Scene of an Incident & First Aid

WHAT IT IS At an incident, make the scene safe, get help and give basic first aid. Knowing DR ABC can save a life.

DR ABC: FIRST AID IN ORDER

1 D · Danger

Check for danger. Switch off engines, warn traffic, stop anyone smoking.

2 R · Response

Ask questions and gently shake their shoulders to get a response.

3 A · Airway

No response? Put your fingers under their chin and lift it forward to open the airway.

4 B · Breathing

Check for normal breathing. No signs of breathing? Start CPR: 5 to 6 cm deep, about twice a second.

5 C · Circulation

Responsive and breathing? Check for bleeding. Press firmly on the wound unless something is in it.

KEY FACTS

LAW In a collision causing damage or injury, you MUST stop. Give your details, or report it to the police within 24 hours.

- Call 999 or 112 and give the exact location and the number of vehicles involved.
- Don't move casualties who are still in vehicles unless there is further danger.
- Don't remove a motorcyclist's helmet unless it is essential.
- Don't give casualties anything to eat or drink. Keep them warm and reassure them.
- Burns: cool with clean, cool water for at least 20 minutes.

EASILY CONFUSED

Burns
- Cool with water for at least 20 minutes
- Don't remove anything stuck to the burn

vs

Bleeding
- Press firmly on the wound
- Something in it? Pad around it

HOW IT SHOWS UP ON THE TEST

Q1 An adult casualty is not breathing normally. How deep should chest compressions be?

- **A 5 to 6 cm** ✓
- B 1 to 2 cm
- C 10 to 12 cm
- D As deep as possible

Why: Press hard and fast in the centre of the chest, 5 to 6 cm deep, at about twice a second.

TRAPS

Burns: cool for at least 20 minutes with plenty of clean, cool water. Don't remove anything stuck to it.

Don't take off a motorcyclist's helmet unless it is essential.

Don't give a casualty anything to drink, not even water.

SOURCES The Highway Code, Annex 7 (First aid on the road) · The Highway Code, Rule 286 (If you are involved in a collision) · The Highway Code, Rule 283 (Incidents)

Tunnels & Vehicle Fires

WHAT IT IS Tunnels reduce visibility, so keep a bigger gap. If your vehicle catches fire, get everyone out to a safe place and call the fire brigade.

IF YOUR VEHICLE CATCHES FIRE

1. **Stop safely**
   If you can, stop in a place of relative safety and switch off the engine.
2. **Hazard lights on**
   Use your hazard warning lights to warn other traffic.
3. **Get everyone out**
   Get the occupants out quickly and to a safe place.
4. **Keep the bonnet shut**
   Don't try to put out an engine fire: opening the bonnet will make it flare.
5. **Call the fire brigade**
   Call 999 with the exact location. Wait well away from the vehicle and traffic.

KEY FACTS

- At night or in poor visibility, don't wear tinted glasses or visors if they restrict your vision.
- Keep at least a two-second gap in a tunnel.
- If you have to stop in a tunnel, leave at least a 5-metre gap to the vehicle in front.
- Breakdown or incident: hazard lights on, then keep well away from your vehicle and moving traffic.
- Engine fire anywhere: get everyone out to a safe place and call 999. Don't open the bonnet.

EASILY CONFUSED

Gap in a tunnel
- Moving: at least a two-second gap
- Stopped: at least 5 metres

VS

Engine fire
- Get everyone out to a safe place
- Don't open the bonnet; call 999

HOW IT SHOWS UP ON THE TEST

Q1 You have to stop in a tunnel. What gap should you leave to the vehicle in front?

- **A At least 5 metres** ✓
- B At least 1 metre
- C At least 2 metres
- D At least 20 metres

Why: Leave at least a 5-metre gap when you stop in a tunnel. When moving, keep at least a two-second gap.

TRAPS

Stopping in a tunnel? Leave at least a 5-metre gap to the vehicle in front.

Don't try to put out an engine fire: opening the bonnet will make the fire flare.

Tinted glasses or visors that restrict your vision: not at night or in poor visibility.

SOURCES The Highway Code, Rule 126 (Stopping distances, tunnels) · The Highway Code, Annex 6 (Vehicle maintenance, safety and security): Overheated engines or fire · The Highway Code, Rules 275 to 283 (Breakdowns and incidents) · The Highway Code, Rule 94 (Vision)